

Fall 2023

Research
March 2024

NJ TRANSIT

Customer Satisfaction Survey Background

- Covers all modes – Bus, Rail, Light Rail & Access Link
- Conducted in Spring and Fall
- Methodology has remained consistent to track scores over time
  - Customers rate their satisfaction with service traits on a scale of 0 to 10
  - Customers identify the most important service traits
- Survey is administered online with an extensive campaign to increase participation and boost response rates in target markets

Customer Satisfaction Survey

Spring 2023 Survey Background

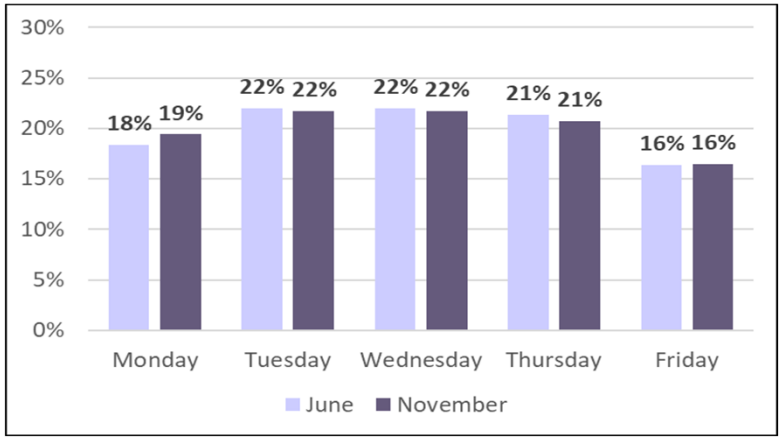
- Conducted from November 1st through November 30th
- Received about 36,000 surveys
- Survey included standard Customer Satisfaction questions and COVID-related questions
- To encourage more participation -- offered 250 NJT Rewards Points to all customers that completed the survey and were a member or signed up for NJT Rewards

NJ TRANSIT

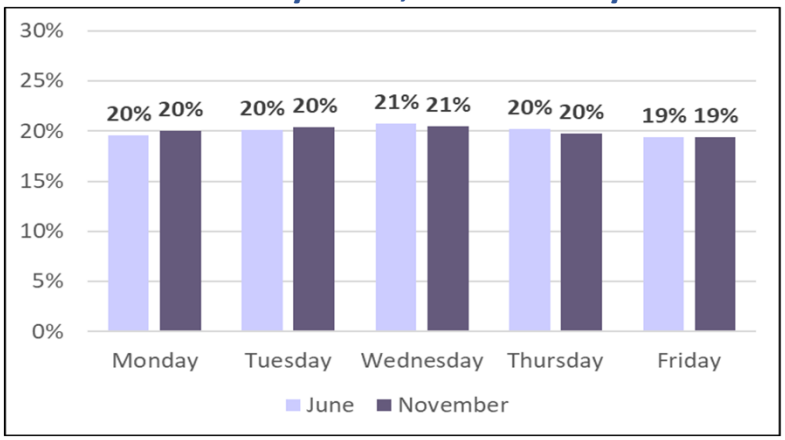
COVID-Related Findings
Distribution of Weekday Work Trips on NJ TRANSIT by Day of the Week

Customer Satisfaction Survey
Fall 2023

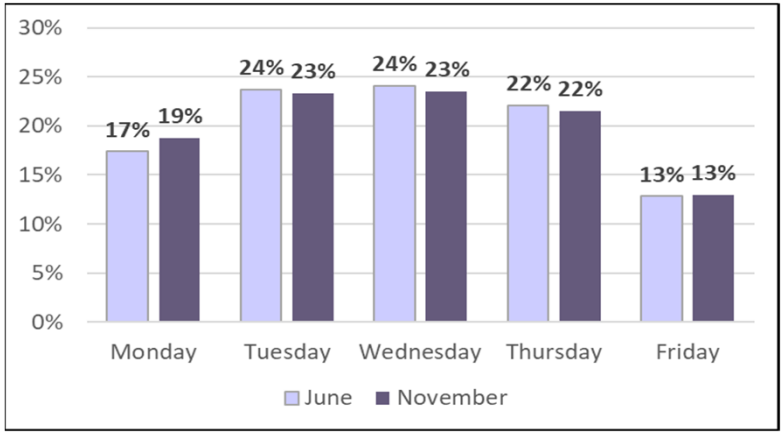
Bus – NY Interstate



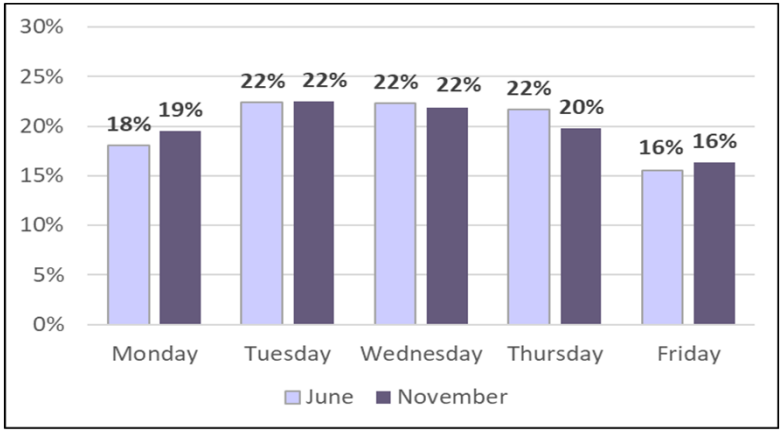
Bus – North Jersey Local, South Jersey & Contract



Rail



Light Rail



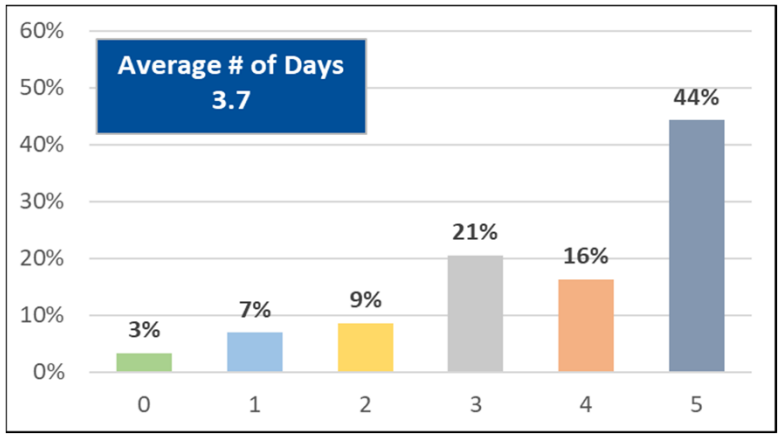
- Most NY work trips continue to occur during the middle of the week
- The fewest customers travel to the office or worksite on Fridays

NJ TRANSIT

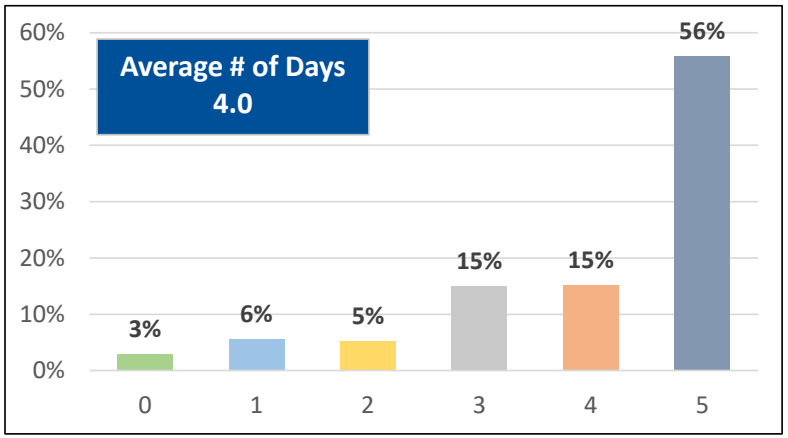
COVID-Related Findings
In the last 7 days, how many days did you travel to your office/worksite?

Customer Satisfaction Survey
Fall 2023

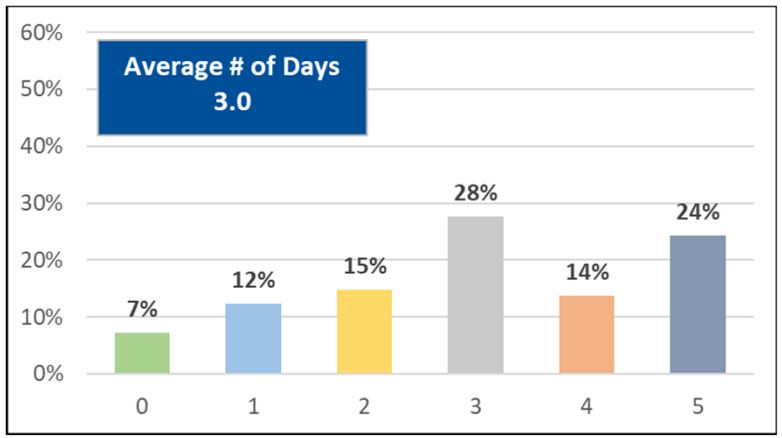
Bus – NY Interstate



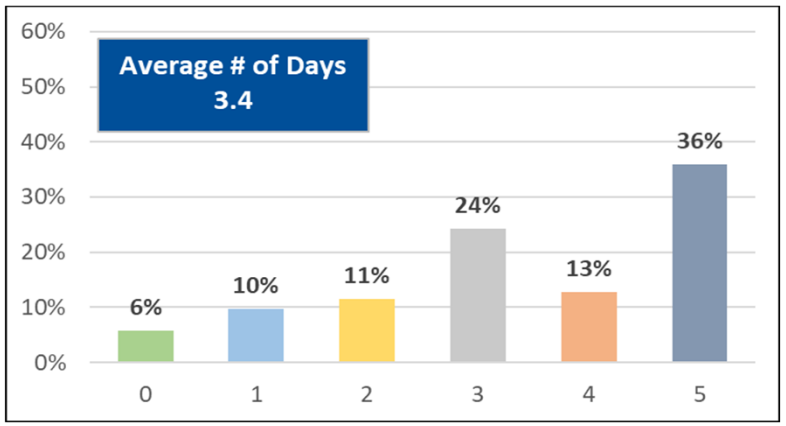
Bus – North Jersey Local, South Jersey & Contract



Rail



Light Rail



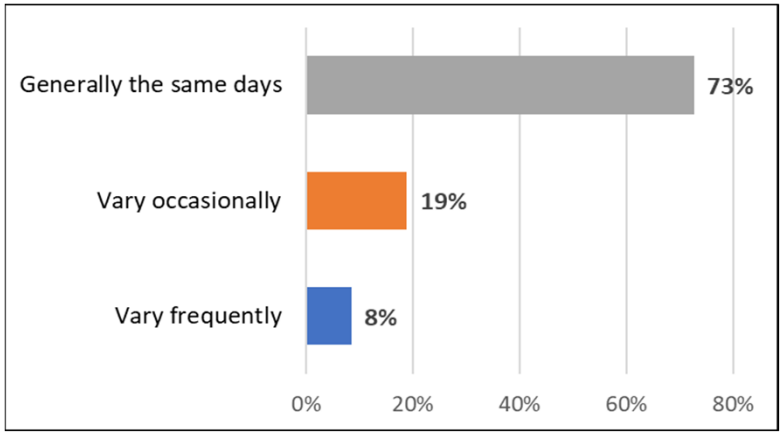
- Local bus market rider trip frequency is highest (4.0 days)
- Rail market rider work trip frequency is lowest (3.0 days)

TRANSIT

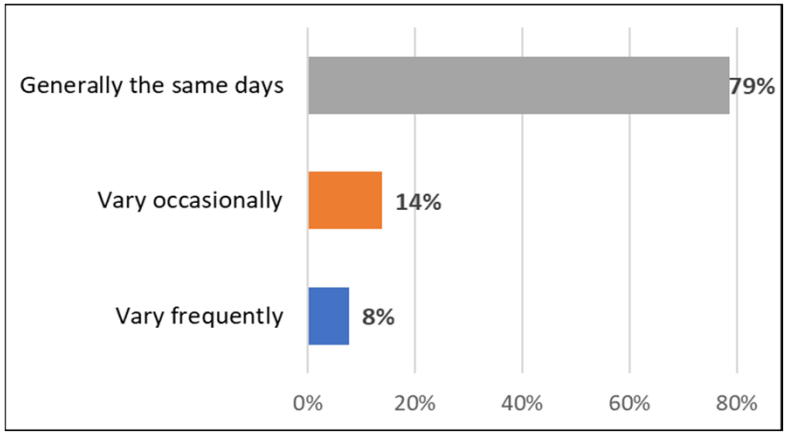
COVID-Related Findings
The Days I Travel to the Office/Worksite . . .

Customer Satisfaction Survey
Fall 2023

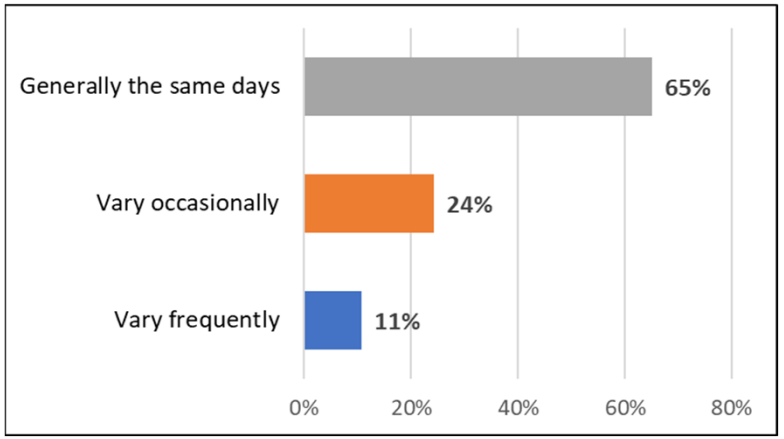
Bus – NY Interstate



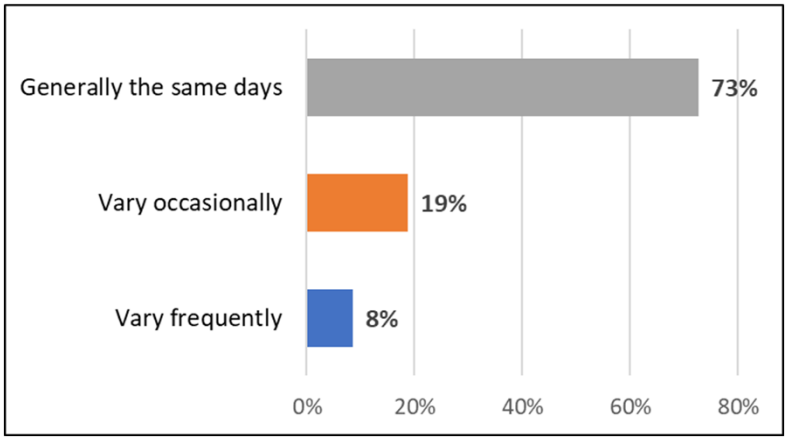
Bus – North Jersey Local, South Jersey & Contract



Rail



Light Rail



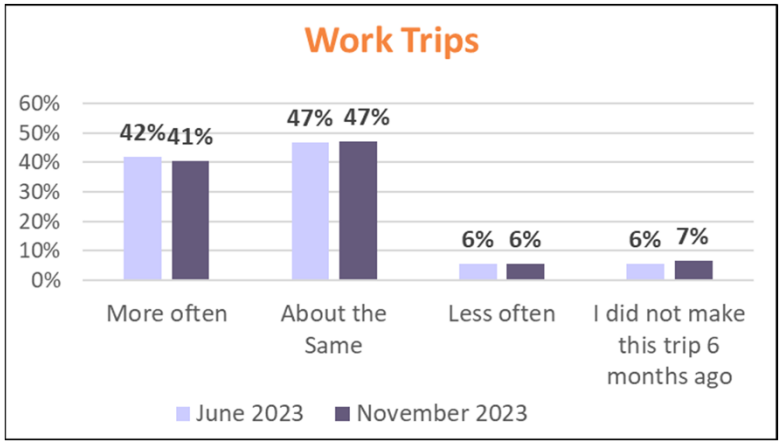
- Most customers go to the office or worksite on the same days each week
- 11 percent or less vary their worksite days frequently.

TRANSIT

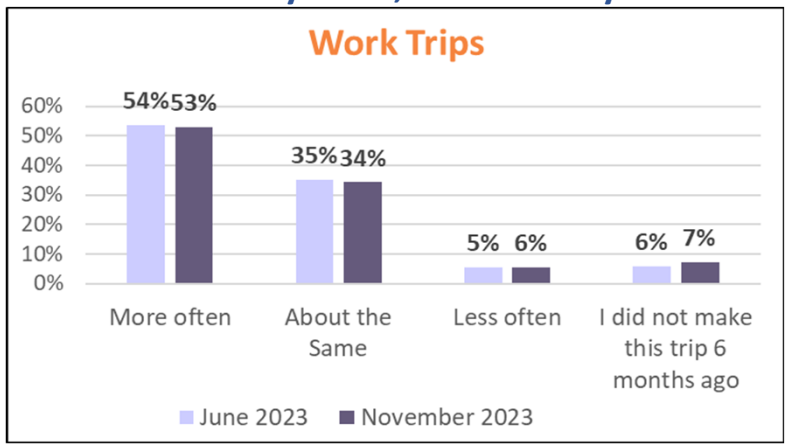
Are you traveling by NJ TRANSIT to WORK
More Often, Less Often or about the Same as 6 months ago – Jan & Nov Survey Data

Customer Satisfaction Survey
Fall 2023

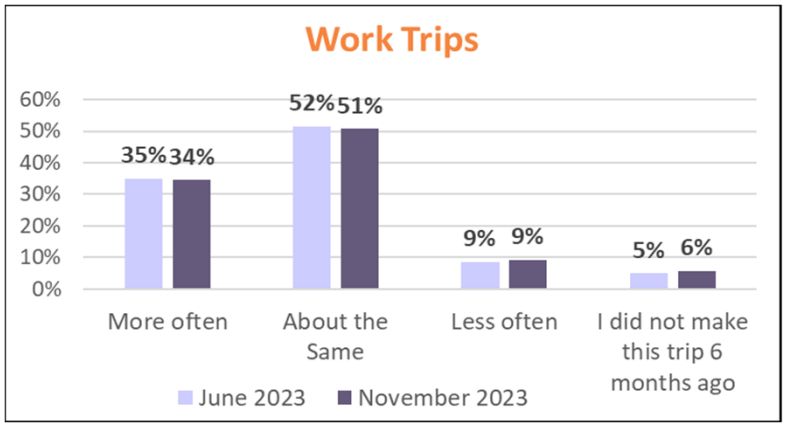
Bus – NY Interstate



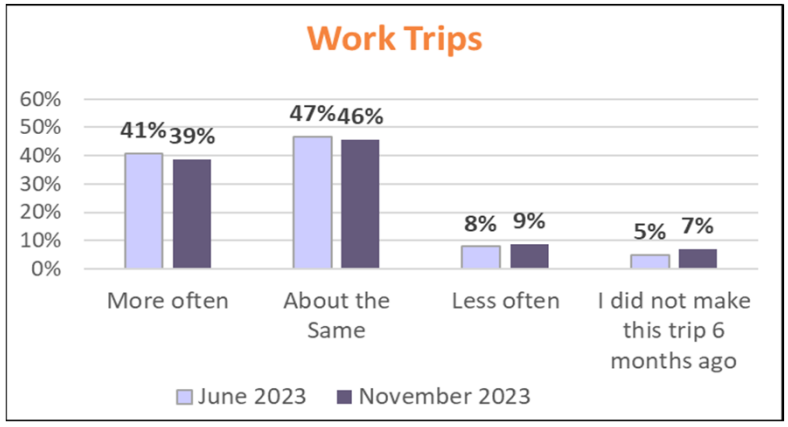
Bus – North Jersey Local, South Jersey & Contract



Rail



Light Rail



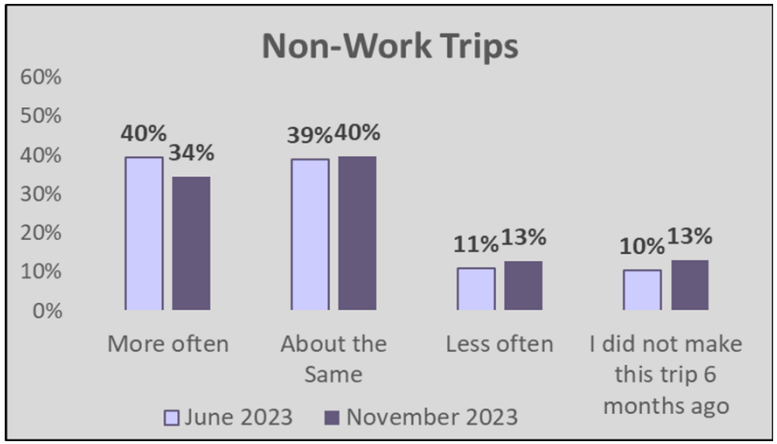
- About half the local bus customers are making more Work trips on NJ TRANSIT than 6 months ago.
- About half the NY Bus, Rail & Light rail customers are making the same number of Work trips .

TRANSIT

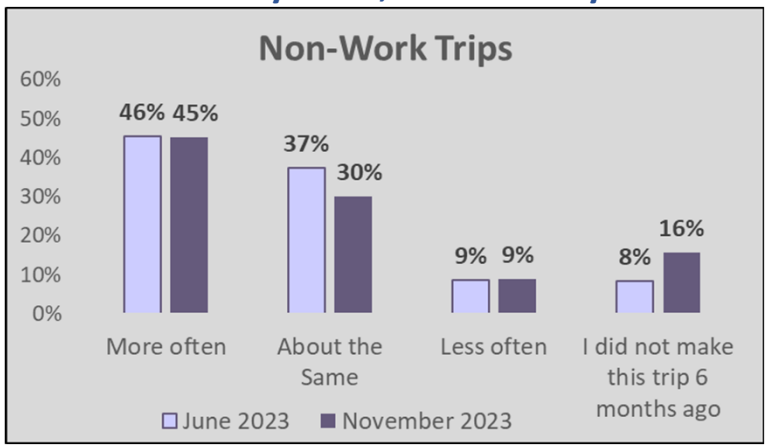
Are you currently traveling by NJ TRANSIT for a Non-Work trip
More Often, Less Often or about the Same as 6 months ago – Jan & Nov Survey Data

Customer Satisfaction Survey
Fall 2023

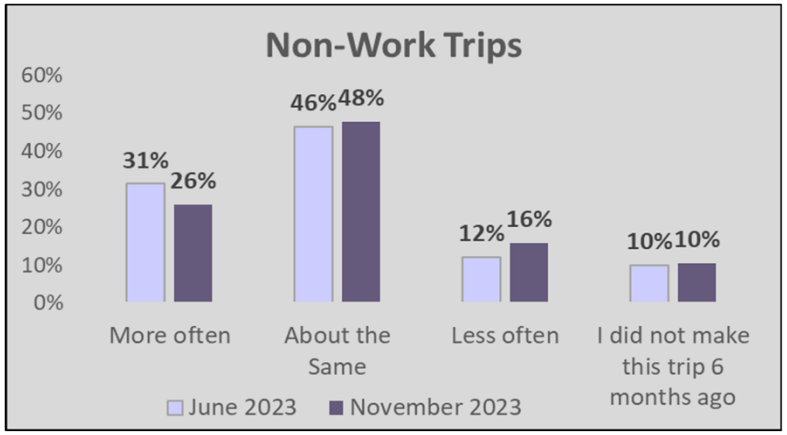
Bus – NY Interstate



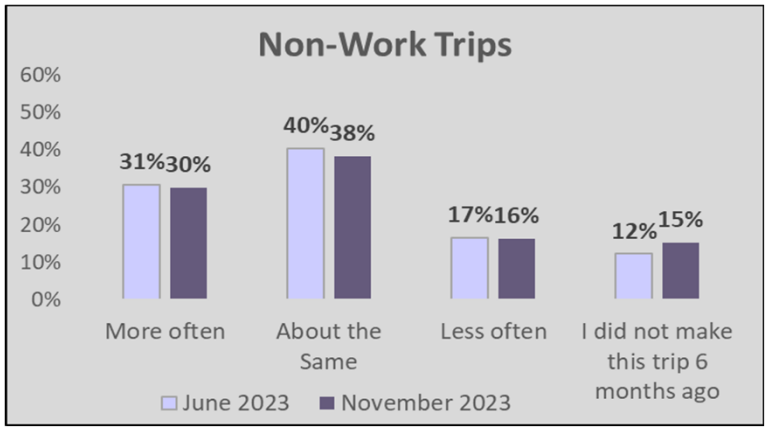
Bus – North Jersey Local, South Jersey & Contract



Rail



Light Rail



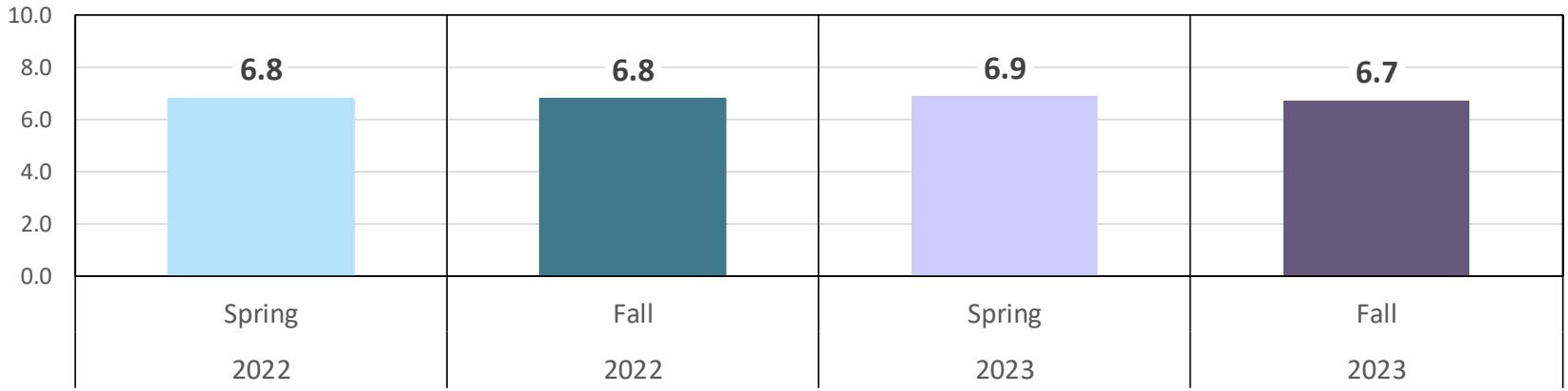
- Customers were making more or about the same number of **Non-Work** trips on NJ TRANSIT than 6 months ago.

TRANSIT

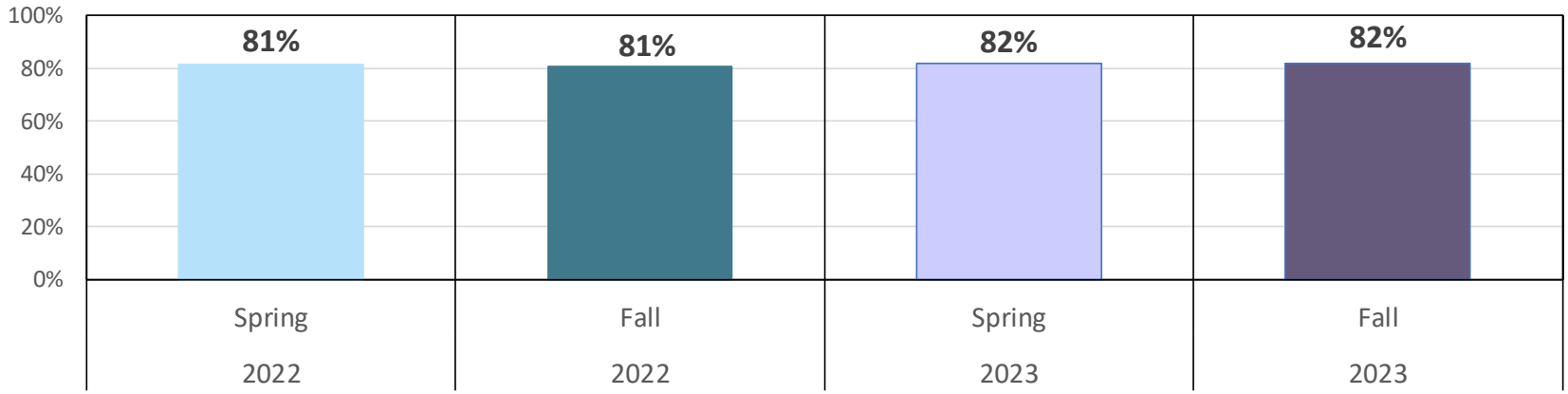
System-Wide Results

Fall 2023

OVERALL SATISFACTION WITH NJ TRANSIT SCORE



LIKELIHOOD TO RECOMMEND NJ TRANSIT

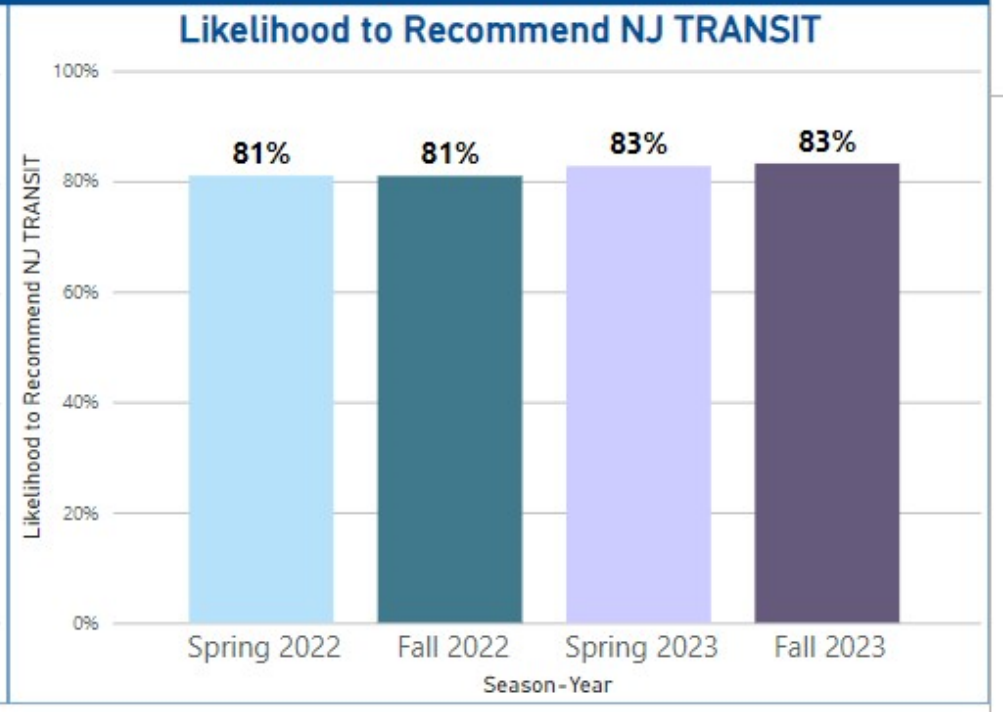


Customer Satisfaction Survey

Fall 2023

Bus System

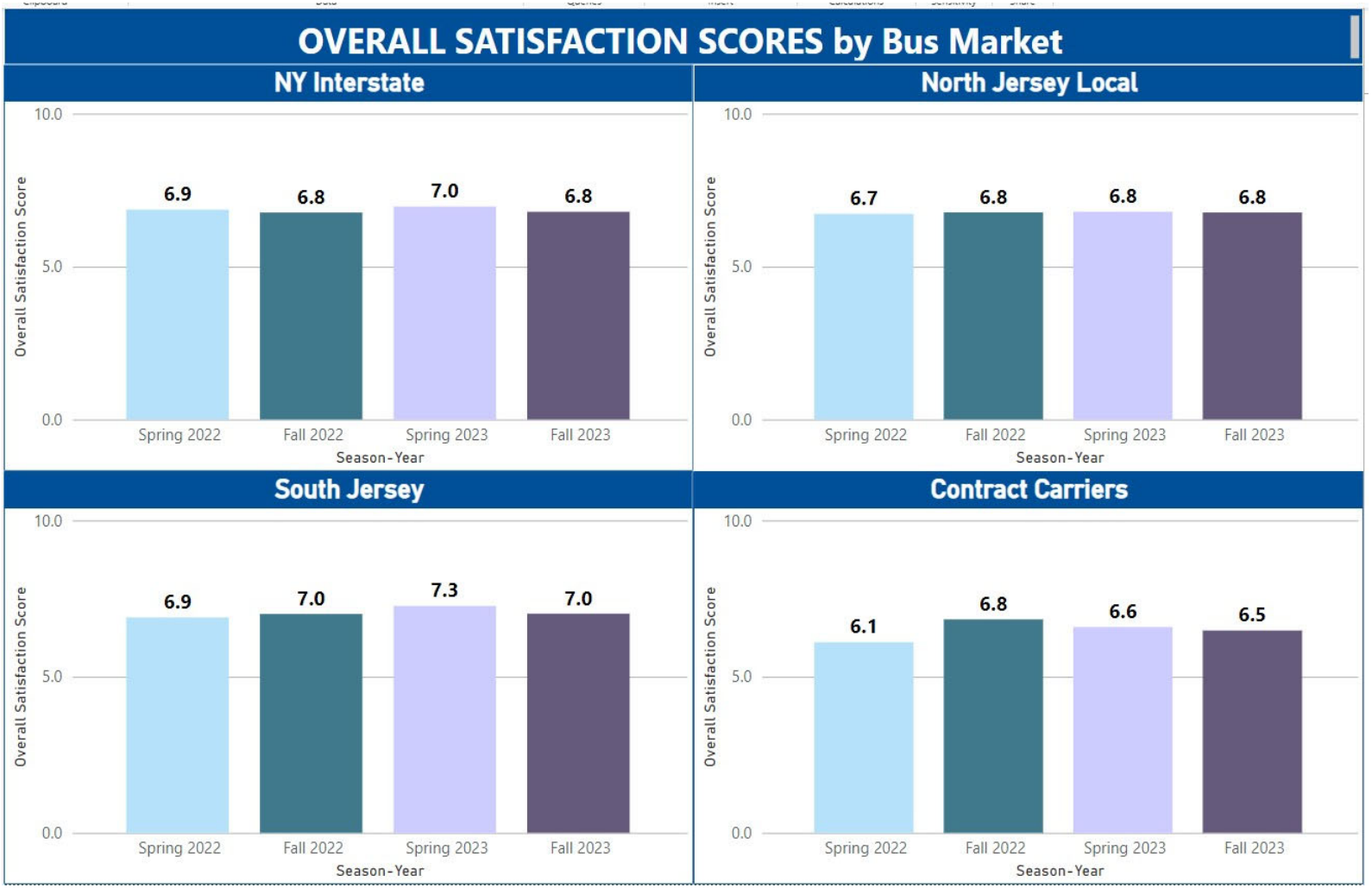




TRANSIT

Customer Satisfaction Survey

Fall 2023



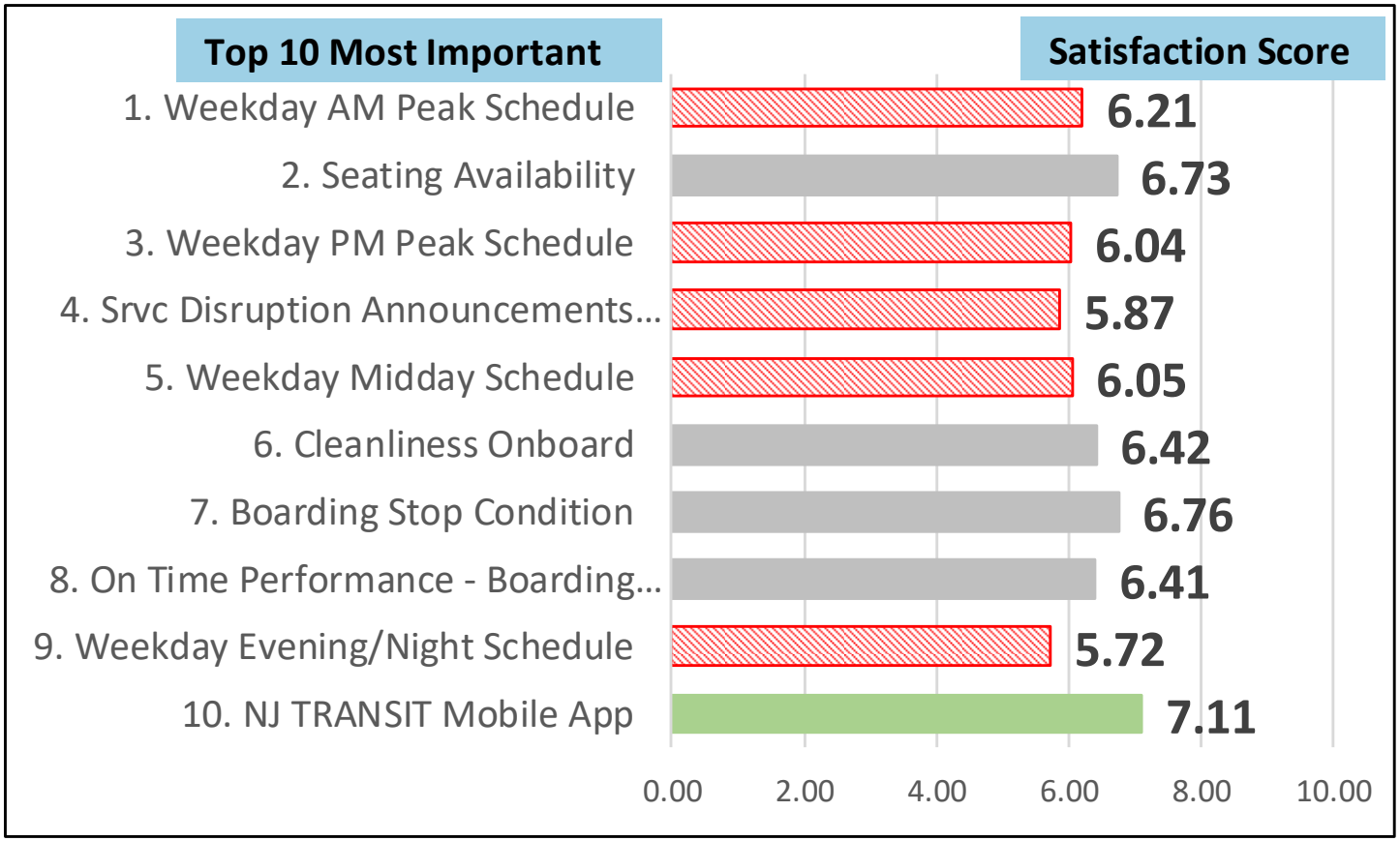
- The results shown here from the last four surveys are all since COVID has subsided.
- The scores have remained generally consistent.

NJ TRANSIT

Top 10 Most Important Service Traits for BUS

Customer Satisfaction Survey
Fall 2023

BUS SYSTEM



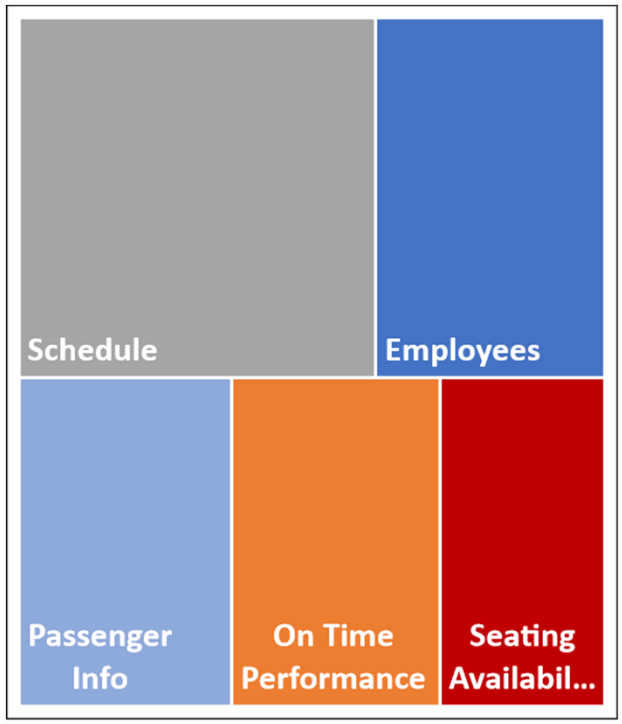
	Top 10 Satisfaction Score
	Bottom 10 Satisfaction Score
	Mid-Range Satisfaction Score

NJ TRANSIT

Top Topic Areas of BUS Comments

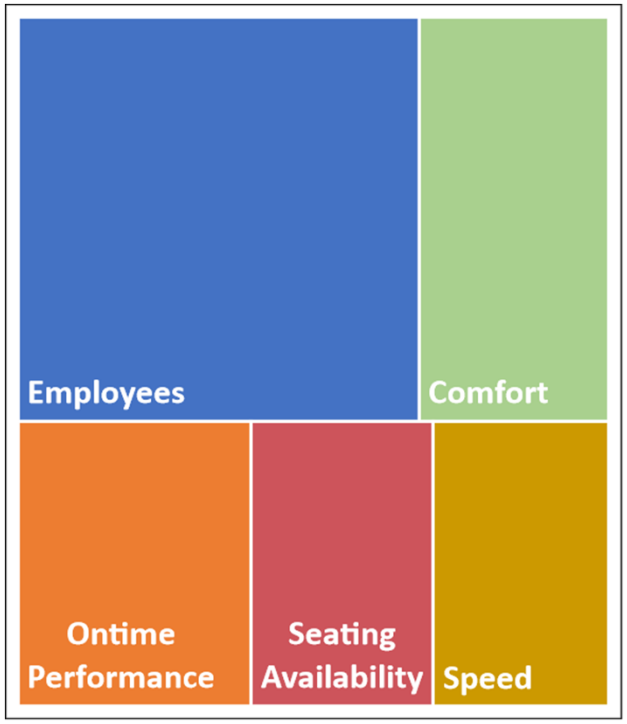
Customer Satisfaction Survey
Fall 2023

What is one thing we can do to **IMPROVE** your travel experience?



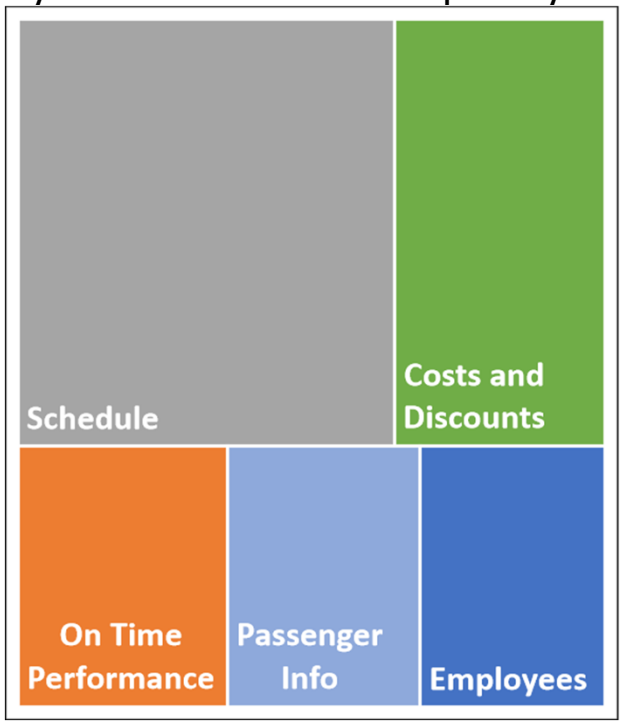
9,429 "Improve" Comments

What is one thing that you **LIKED** about your trip on NJ TRANSIT?



9,086 "Liked" Comments

What are the actions we could take to **ENCOURAGE** you to travel by NJ TRANSIT more frequently?



8,779 "Encourage" Comments

15,186 Bus Surveys

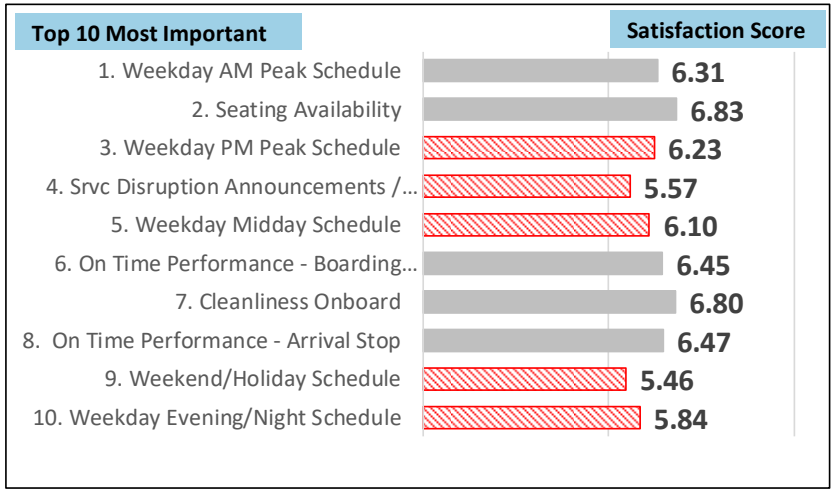
NJ TRANSIT

Top 10 Most Important Service Traits for BUS Customers by Bus Market and Score

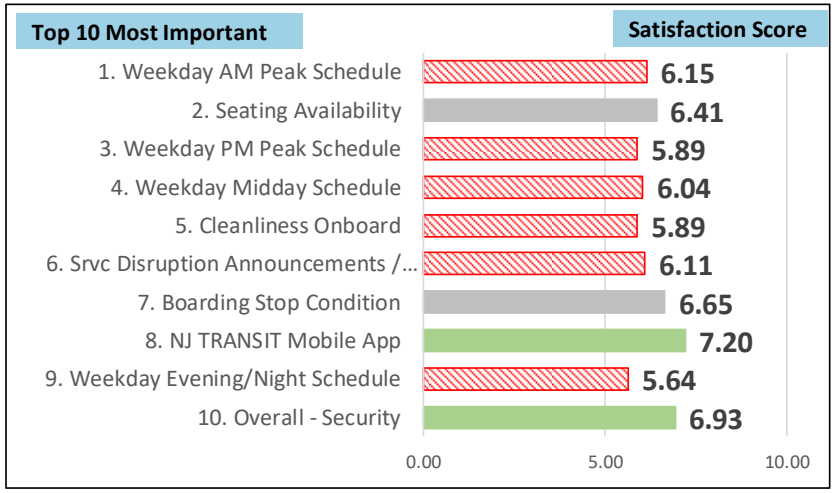
Customer Satisfaction Survey
Fall 2023

	Top 10 Satisfaction Score
	Bottom 10 Satisfaction Score
	Mid-Range Satisfaction Score

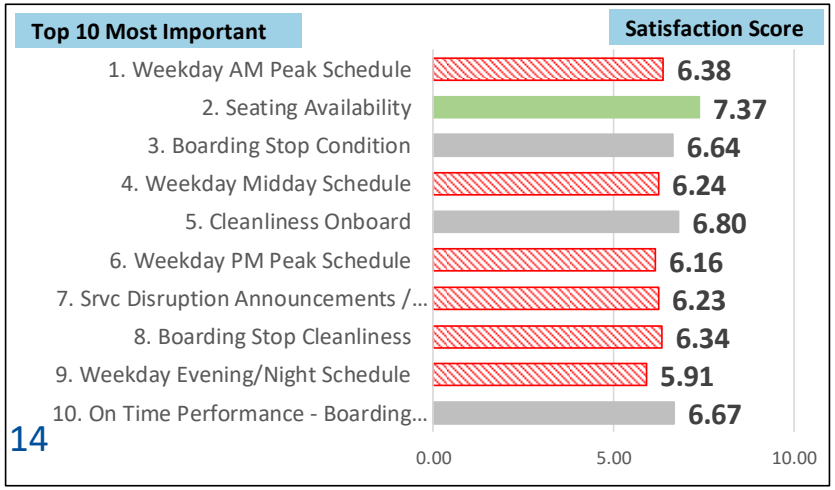
NY INTERSTATE



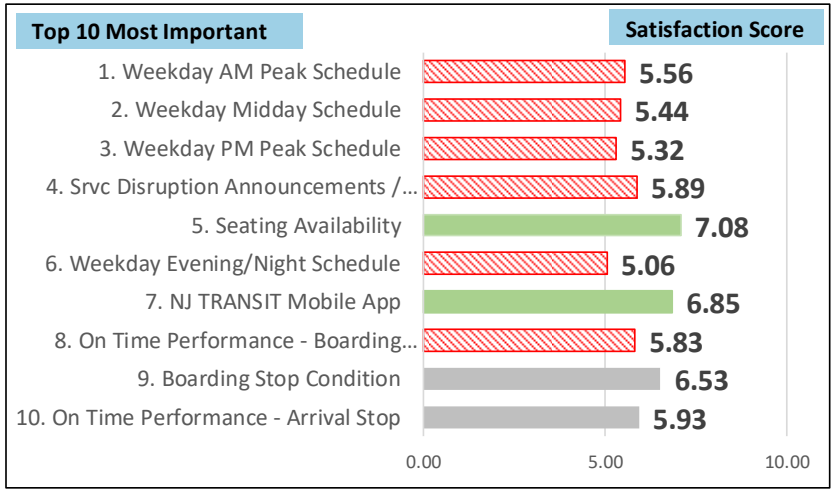
NORTH JERSEY LOCAL



SOUTH JERSEY



CONTRACT CARRIERS



TRANSIT

Customer Satisfaction Survey

Bus Score Context

Bus On-Board Conditions

Slight uptick in satisfaction with comfort and cleanliness on-board for North Jersey local, South Jersey, and Contract Carrier routes, attributed to:

- Continued efforts to onboard additional cleaners to fill existing vacancies throughout the system
- Continued mid-life rehabilitation of 200 of our NABI 2012-2013 model year buses, with 24 buses completed to date

Seating Availability

Satisfaction with seating availability held steady in all markets with only marginal increases and decreases, attributed to:

- Continued strategic use of high-capacity articulated buses on heavy ridership routes to ensure more seating availability for customers
- Ongoing efforts to ramp up bus operator staffing levels to reduce the number of missed trips
- Further enhancing our staffing effort by reinitiating a part-time retiree program with our bus union. adding 42 rehires since June

NJ TRANSIT

Customer Satisfaction Survey

Bus Score Context

Facilities

Satisfaction scores for attributes related to facilities increased for all markets, including NY Interstate:

- Implemented another series of gate changes at PABT in October, realigning some routes to ease congestion and improve customer flow in the terminal by positioning bus lines in proximity to other similar lines
- Off-board fare collection pilot at PABT continues to speed the boarding process for customers
- Expansion of the pilot in December to three additional routes (Nos. 156R, 158, and 159R) should yield positive results for the next survey period

TRANSIT

Customer Satisfaction Survey

Bus Score Context

Scheduling

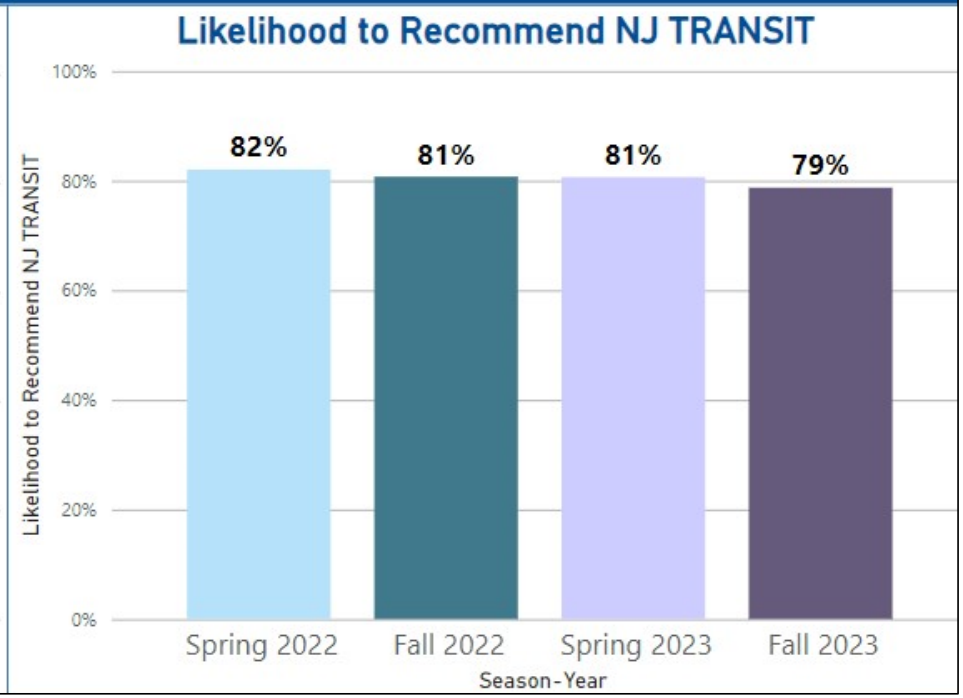
Scores related to Scheduling held relatively steady in all bus markets:

- Between the April and October 2023 service changes, added 1,027 new directly-operated trips and adjusted running times on 107 bus routes to improve reliability
- Made major service additions to several lines:
  - No. 1 in Newark
  - No. 10 serving Bayonne and Jersey City
  - No. 25 serving the Springfield Avenue corridor
  - No. 119 from Bayonne and Jersey City to New York
  - No. 123 serving the Jersey City and Union City areas
  - No. 126 in Hoboken
- Assumed and maintained uninterrupted bus service on three routes for customers in Essex County, after Coach ONE abandoned their privately operated routes in early October
- Assumed and maintained uninterrupted bus service on four routes for Hudson County and Jersey City customers, after the A&C Corporation abandoned their privately operated routes in late October

NJ TRANSIT

Rail System

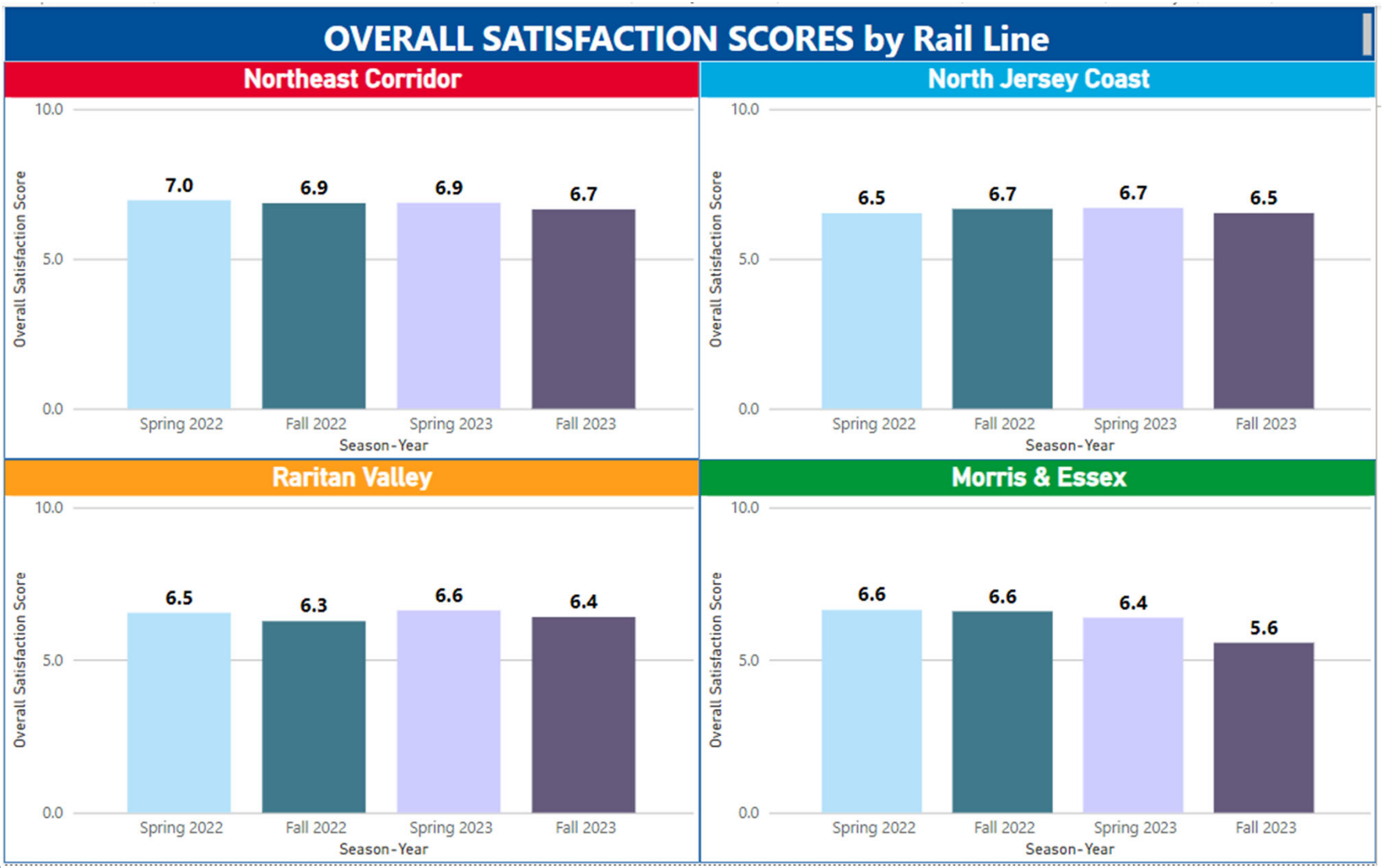

Overall Satisfaction Score
Sum of Overall Satisfaction Score
10.0
8.0
6.0
4.0
2.0
0.0
6.8
6.7
6.7
6.4
Spring 2022
Fall 2022
Spring 2023
Fall 2023
Season-Year


Likelihood to Recommend NJ TRANSIT
Likelihood to Recommend NJ TRANSIT
100%
80%
60%
40%
20%
0%
82%
81%
81%
79%
Spring 2022
Fall 2022
Spring 2023
Fall 2023
Season-Year

Customer Satisfaction Survey

Fall 2023

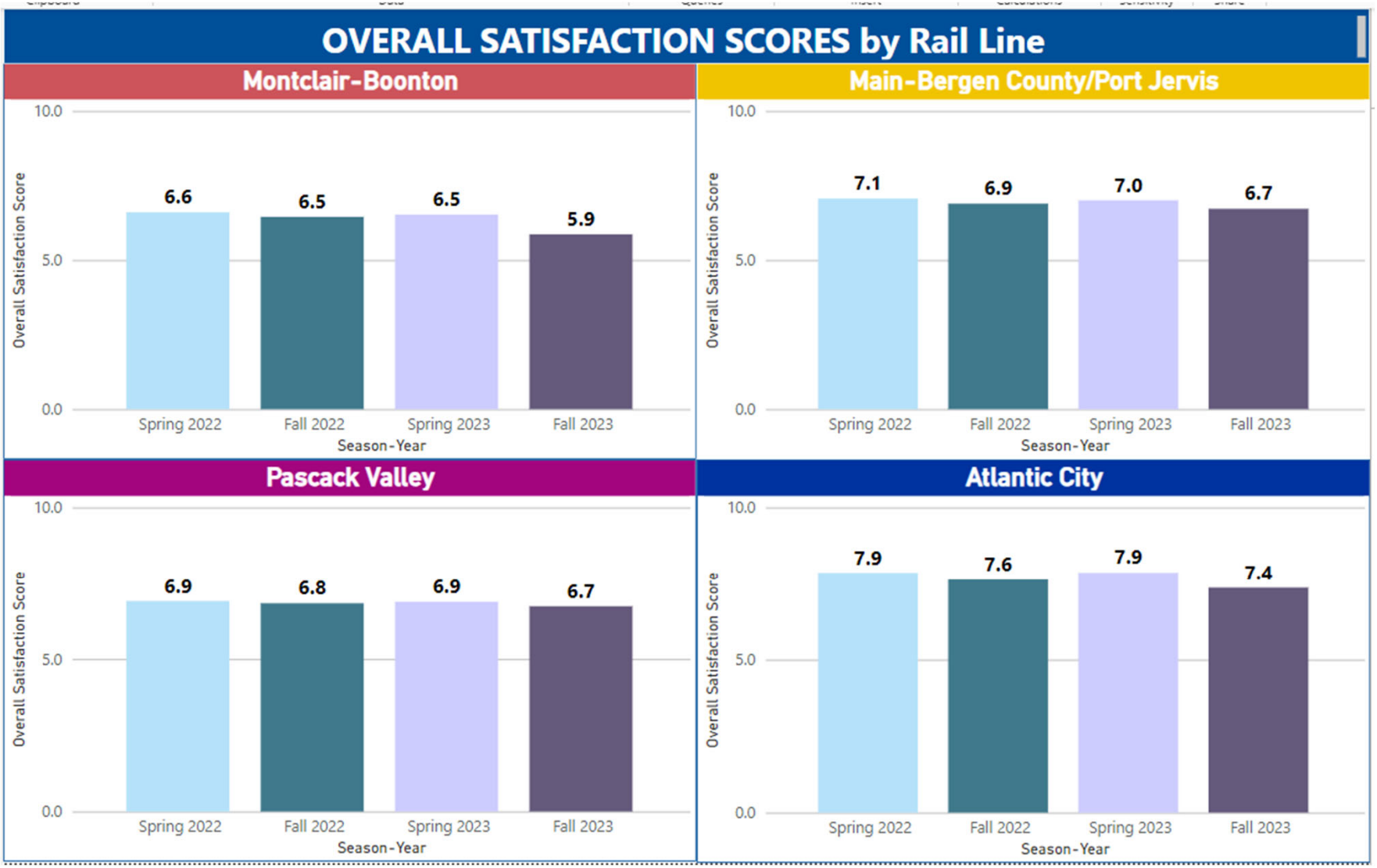
OVERALL SATISFACTION SCORES by Rail Line



TRANSIT

Customer Satisfaction Survey

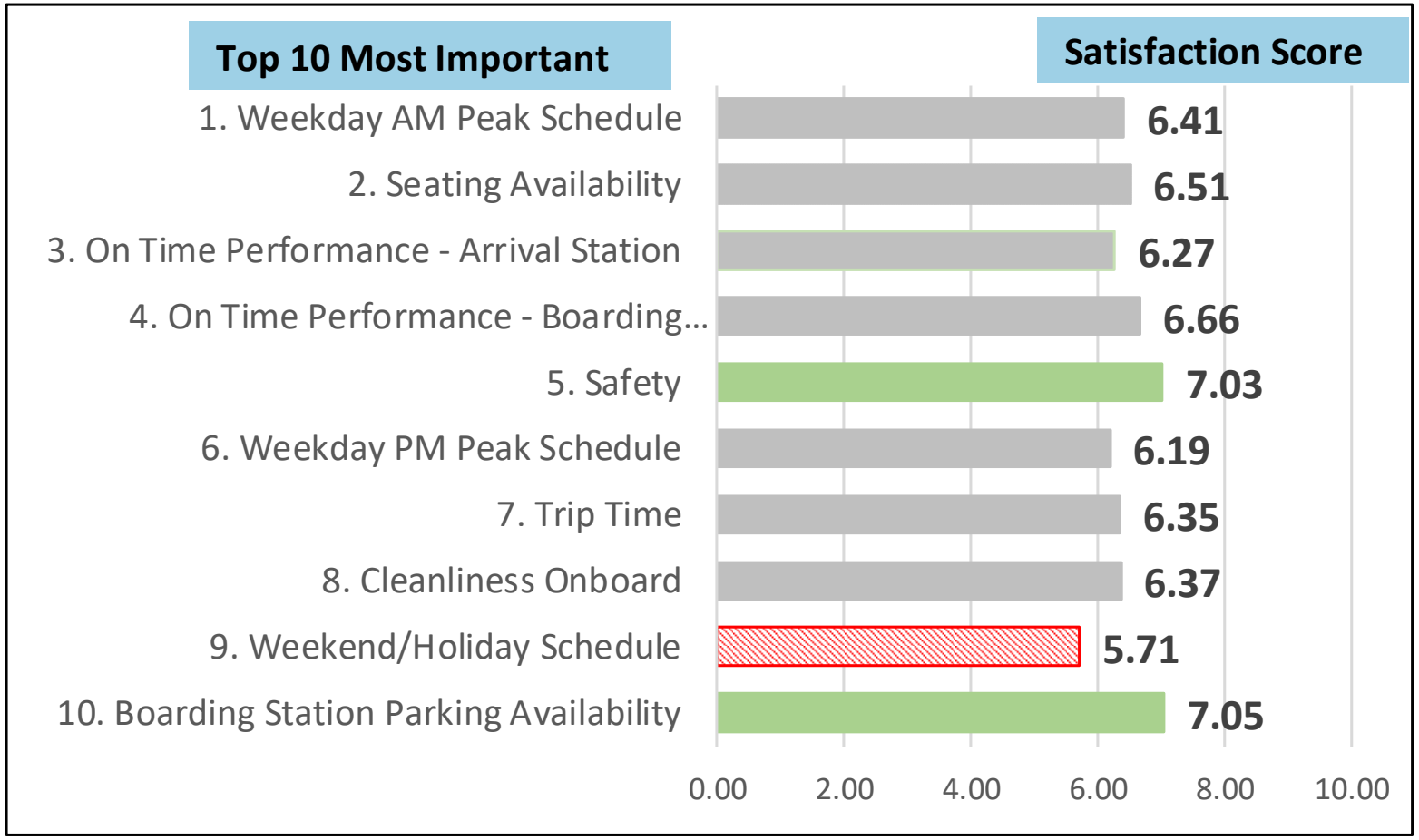
Fall 2023



TRANSIT

Top 10 Most Important Service Traits for RAIL CUSTOMERS

Customer Satisfaction Survey
Fall 2023



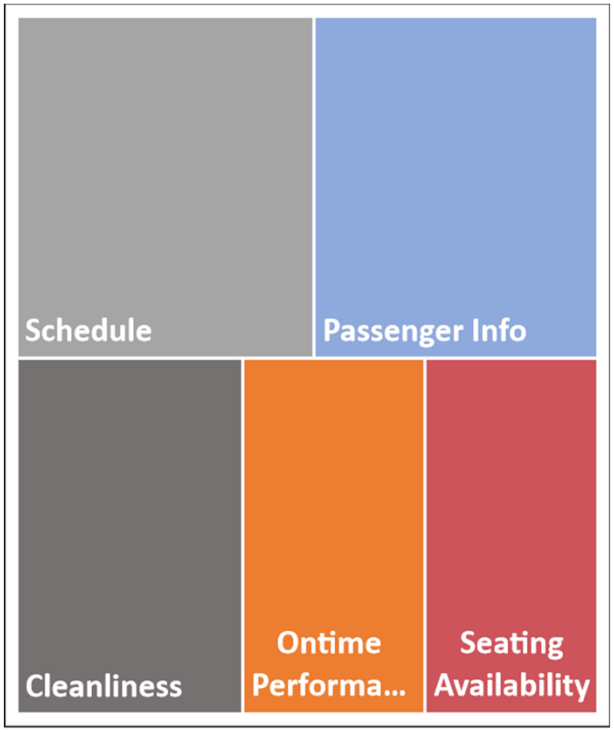
	Top 10 Satisfaction Score
	Bottom 10 Satisfaction Score
	Mid-Range Satisfaction Score

NJ TRANSIT

Top Topic Areas of RAIL Comments

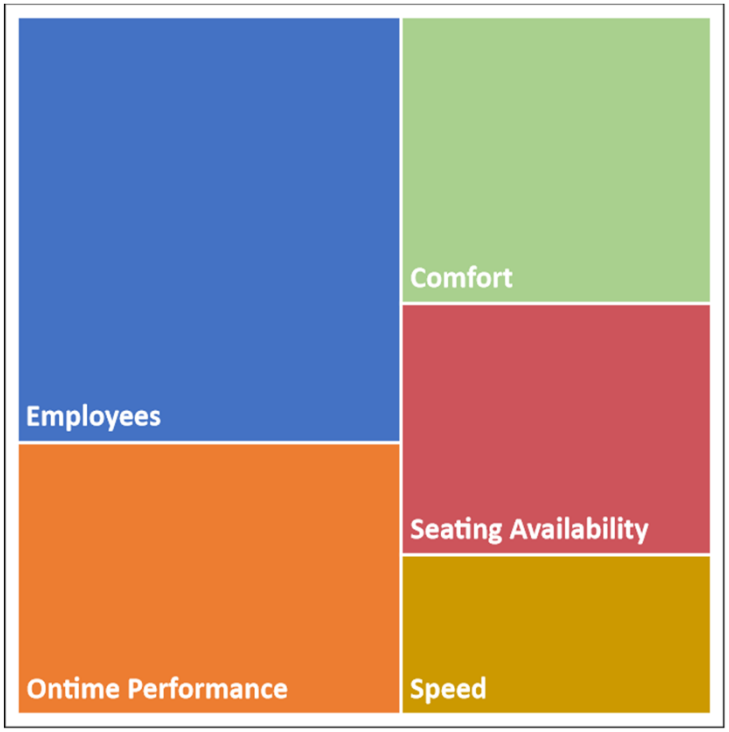
Customer Satisfaction Survey
Fall 2023

What is one thing we can do to **IMPROVE** your travel experience?



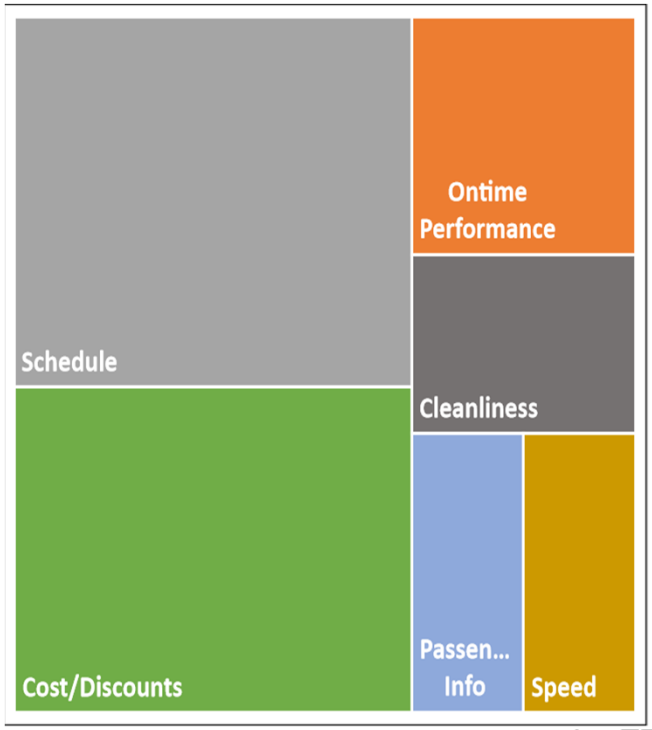
11,258 "Improve" Comments

What is one thing that you **LIKED** about your trip on NJ TRANSIT?



11,916 "Liked" Comments

What are the actions we could take to **ENCOURAGE** you to travel by NJ TRANSIT more frequently?



11,656 "Encourage" Comments

18,377 Rail Surveys

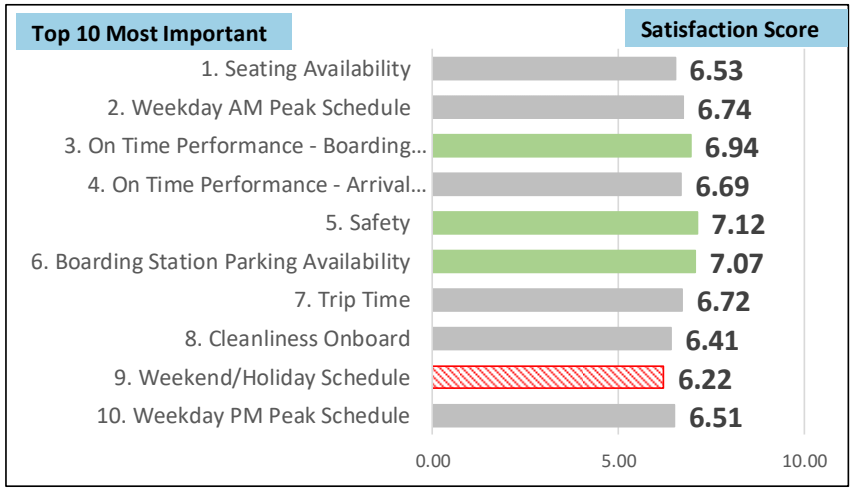
TRANSIT

Top 10 Most Important Service Traits for RAIL Customers by Rail Line and Score

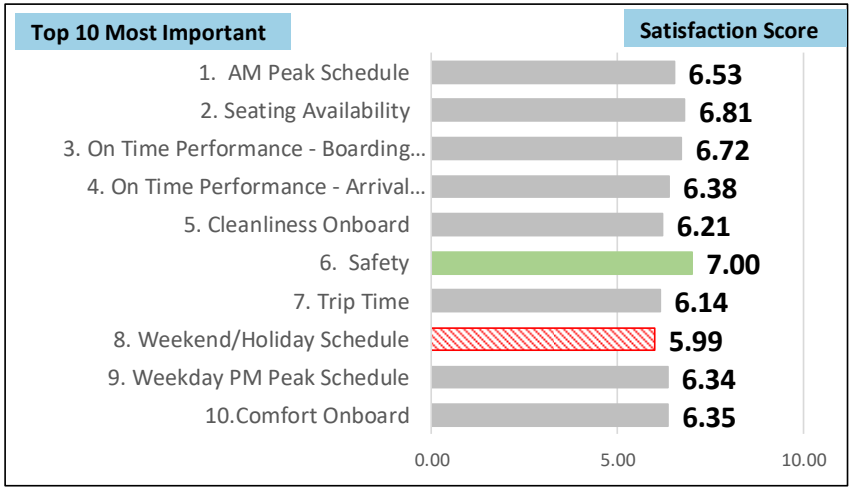
Customer Satisfaction Survey
Fall 2023

	Top 10 Satisfaction Score
	Bottom 10 Satisfaction Score
	Mid-Range Satisfaction Score

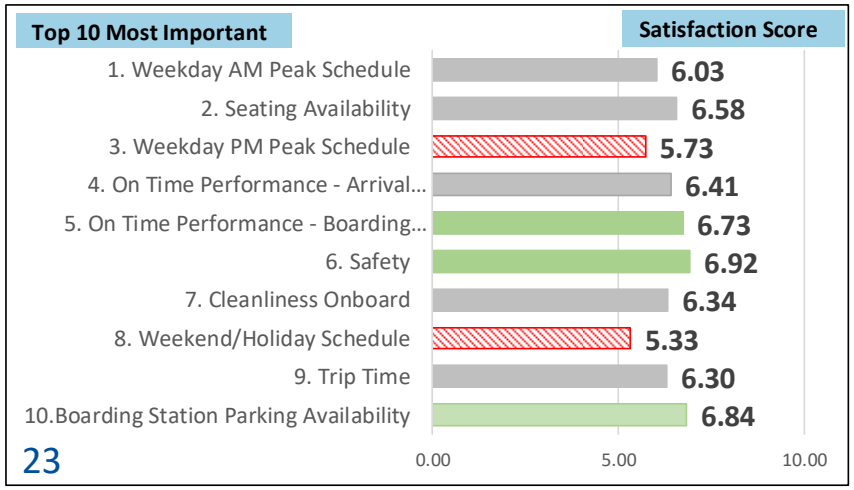
Northeast Corridor



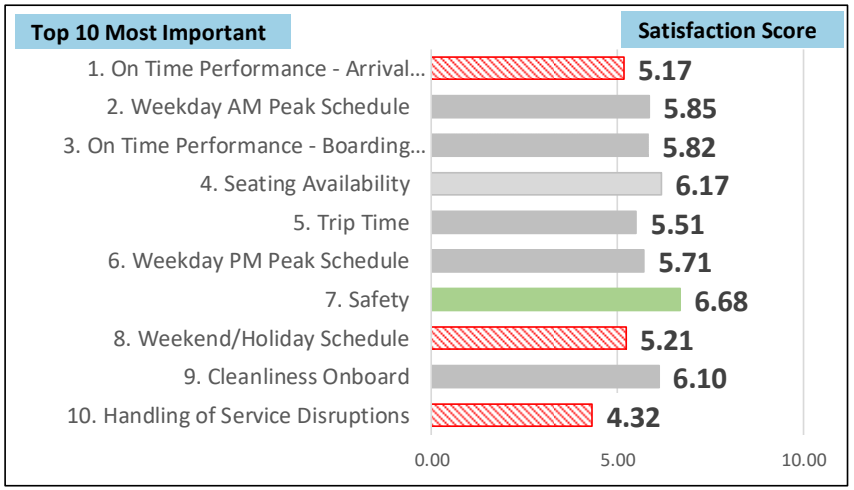
North Jersey Coast



Raritan Valley



Morris & Essex



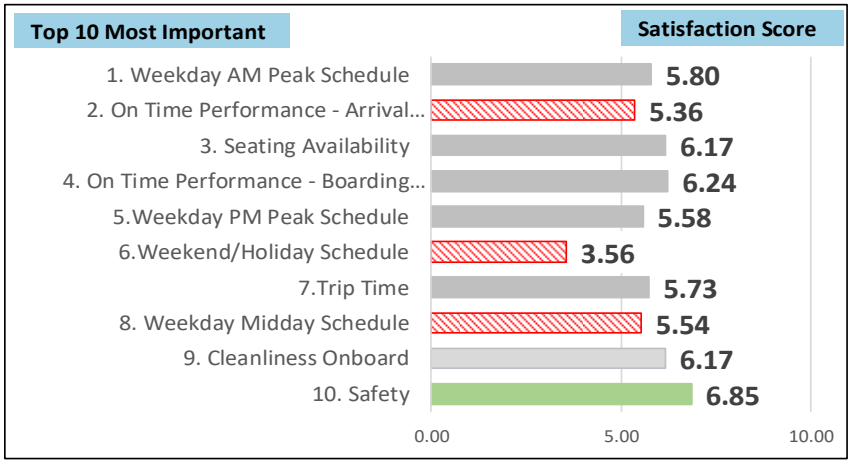
TRANSIT

Top 10 Most Important Service Traits for RAIL Customers by Rail Line and Score

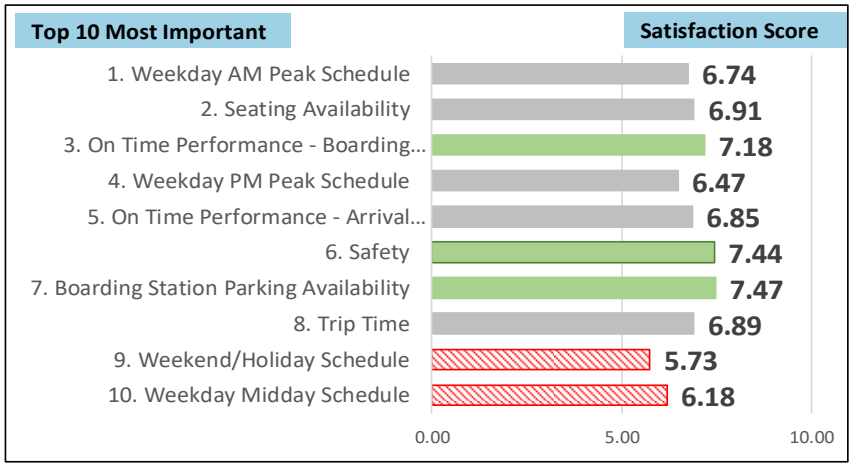
Customer Satisfaction Survey
Fall 2023

	Top 10 Satisfaction Score
	Bottom 10 Satisfaction Score
	Mid-Range Satisfaction Score

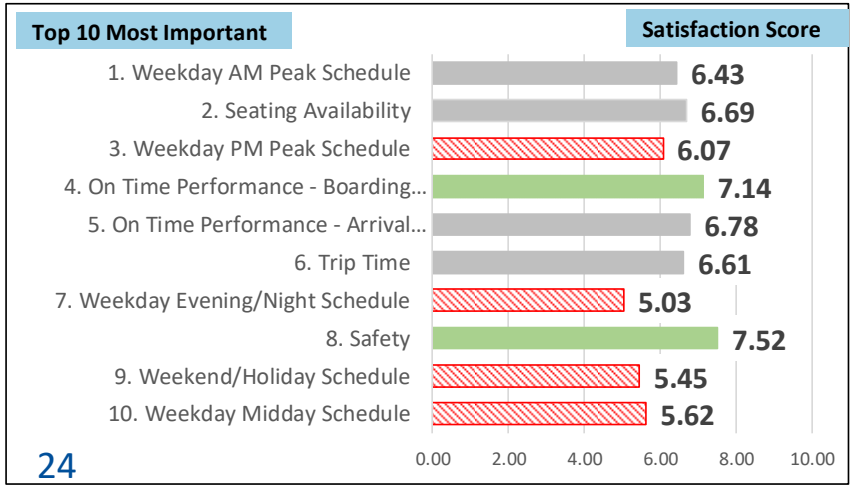
Montclair-Boonton



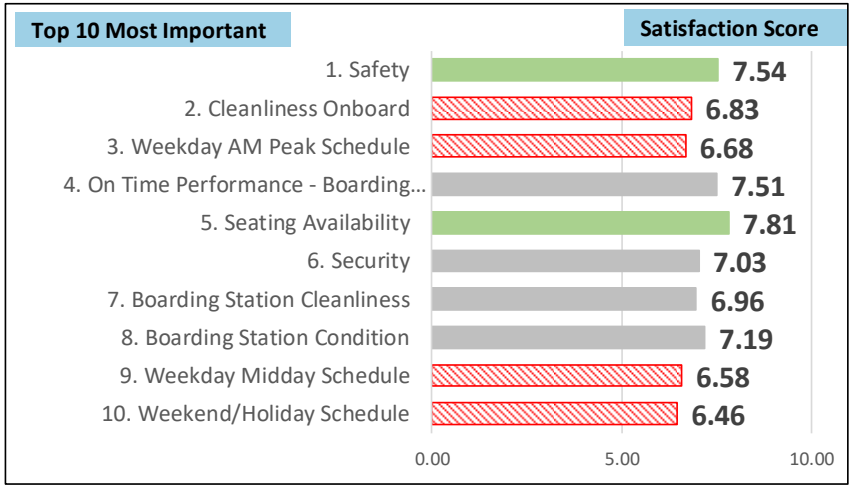
Main-Bergen/Port Jervis



Pascack Valley



ATLANTIC CITY RAIL LINE



TRANSIT

Customer Satisfaction Survey

Rail Score Context

Rail Operations constantly strives to make improvements to enhance the customer experience. Some of the improvements we have made last year are listed below:

- *Hiring/Onboarding Effort*
  - Collaborating with HR, increasing the recruitment efforts for Mechanical-Technical professionals, Conductors, and Locomotive Engineers to bolster service delivery
  - Augmentation of staffing levels accelerates equipment repairs, improves safety on infrastructure projects, meets customer service needs at special events, and ensures out ability to promptly meet customer needs with rapid response to increased service demands

- *Service Planning*
  - Morristown Line – Three (3) a.m. peak Hoboken trains that previously operated from Summit or Morristown, extended to operate from Dover
  - Pascack Valley Line – Retimed off peak weekday trains to improve reliability of the schedule

NJ TRANSIT

Customer Satisfaction Survey

Rail Score Context

- *Service Planning (Cont'd)*
  - Northeast Corridor – Schedule adjustments to accommodate Portal Bridge construction and Amtrak service changes.
- *Web Ticketing*
  - In November 2023, NJ TRANSIT deployed functionality allowing customers to purchase one-way & round-trip tickets via NJTRANSIT.com/webtickets for all rail lines.
- *Mechanical*
  - Continue to roll out the new ALP45A locomotives to improve fleet reliability
  - As we have seen a drop in rating for interior cleanliness, we have implemented a new process to improve the interior cleanliness of fleet.

Customer Satisfaction Survey

Rail Score Context

- *Infrastructure*
  - **Secaucus-fire alarm panel upgrades-*Complete***
  - **Edison- new fiberteck doors installed in waiting room**
  - **Rahway- new LED lighting in tunnel**
  - **Clifton-new LED lighting entire station and parking lot**
  - **Newark and Hoboken Division- new garbage cans system wide - *Complete***
  - **Newark and Hoboken Division- new PID cases and galvanized stands system wide-*Complete***
  - **Metropark- HVAC, new mini split installed comm room-*Complete***
  - **Newark Broad street- new diamond plate metal staircase**
  - **Atlantic City- ticket offices renovations-*Complete***
  - **Bay street- new door elevator room-*Complete***
  - **Absecon- fire alarm panel upgrades- *Complete***
  - **Highland Ave- tunnel spruce up- *Complete***
  - **Morristown- all new benches**
  - **Glen Rock- new LED lighting**
  - **Montvale- new LED lighting- *Complete***
  - **Ridgewood- new LED lighting**
  - **NPS-Historic Globes restoration**
  - **NPS- Waiting room bench Installation (Ongoing Gov Proj)**
  - **NPS-Main Waiting Room Terrazzo Floor Repairs**
  - **NPS-Air curtains**
  - **NPS-Substation #2 A/C replacement- *Complete***
  - **NPS- Market and Main Bus Lane Improvements (drains and repaving) (Capital Project)- *Complete***
  - **NPS- flood doors (Capital Project)- *Complete***
  - ***South Amboy-bird netting, platform recoated, railings painted, all new LED lighting***
  - ***Elberon – platform repairs***

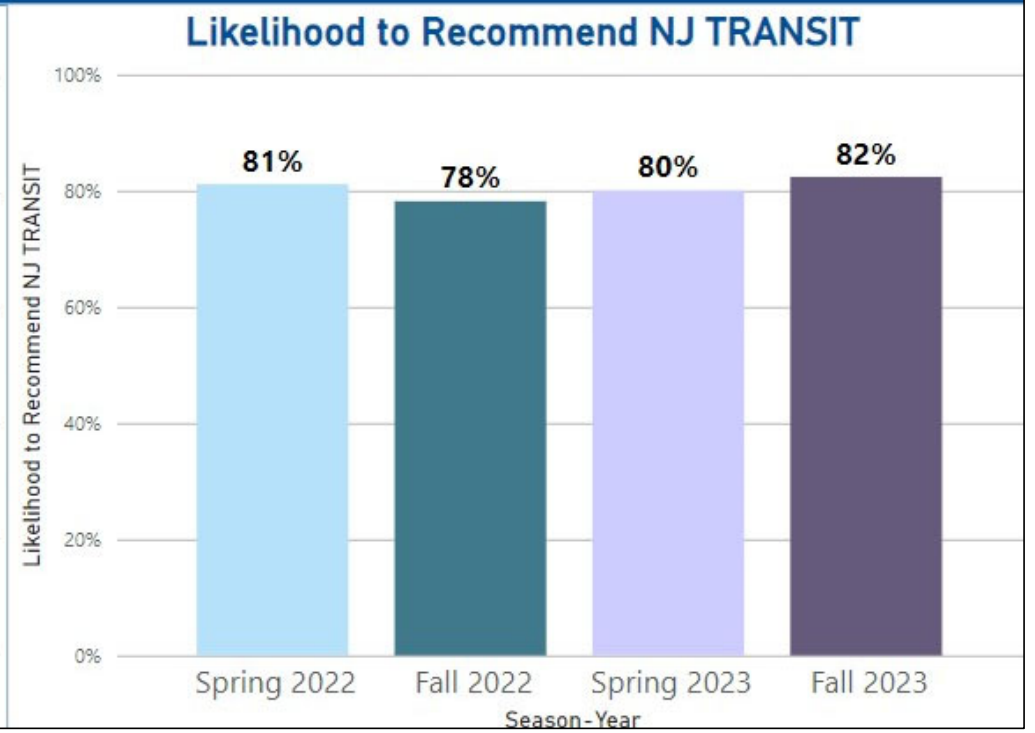
TRANSIT

Customer Satisfaction Survey

Fall 2023

Light Rail System





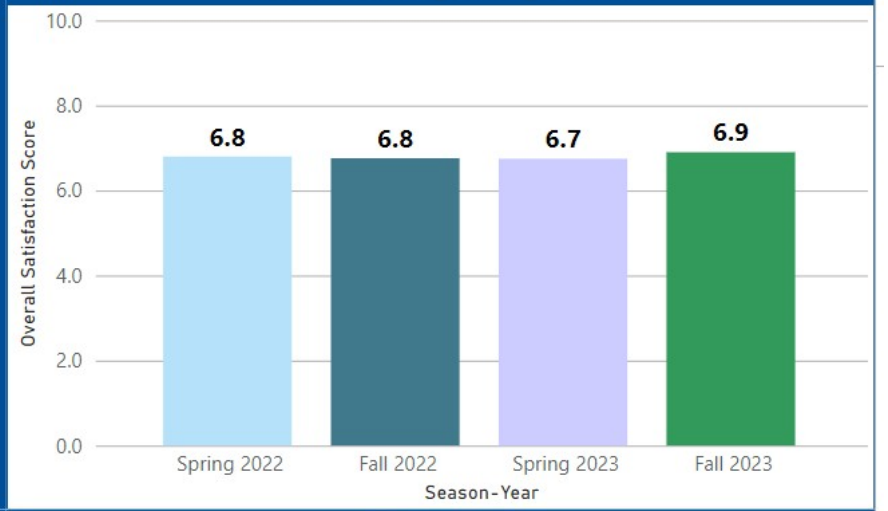
TRANSIT

OVERALL SATISFACTION SCORES by MARKET

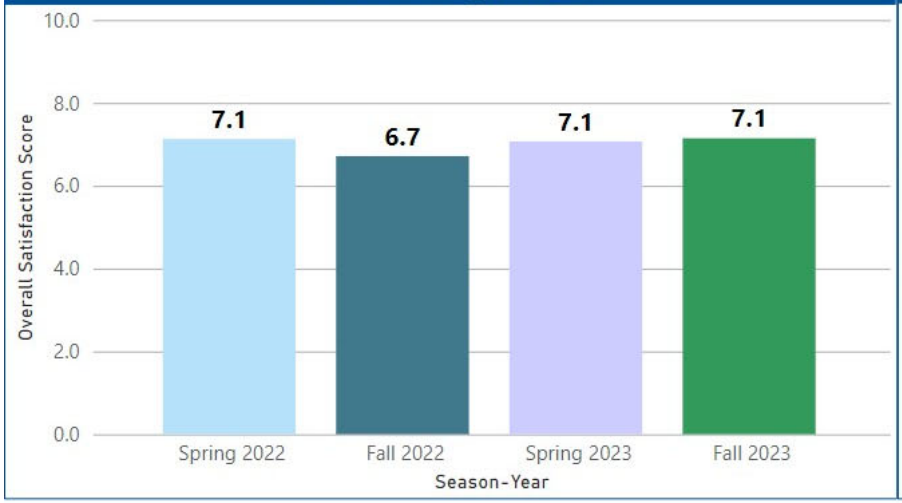
Customer Satisfaction Survey

Fall 2023

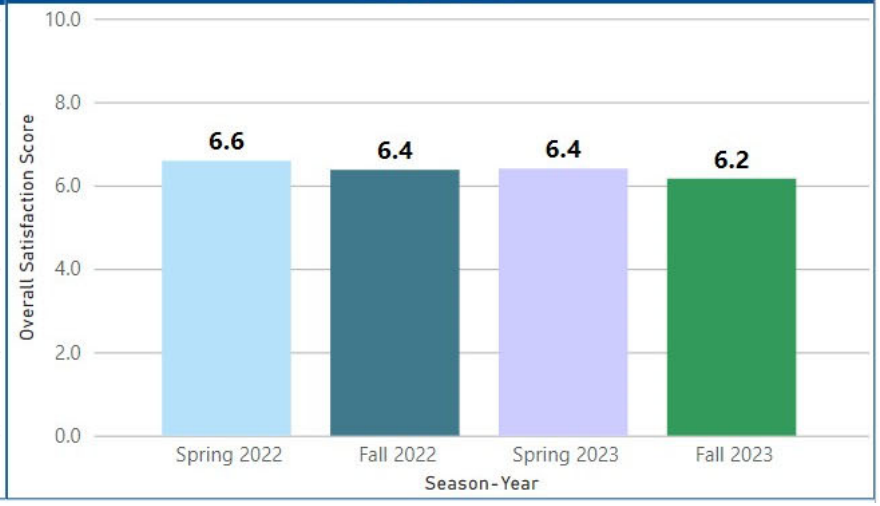
Hudson-Bergen Light Rail



Newark Light Rail



River LINE

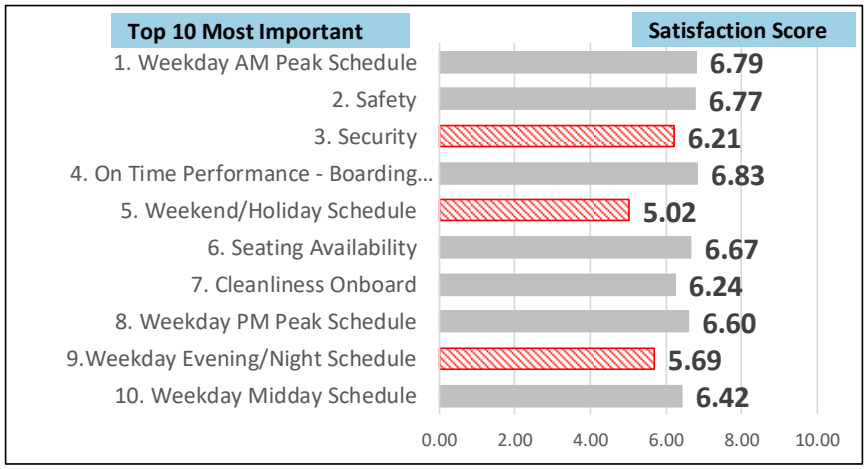


TRANSIT

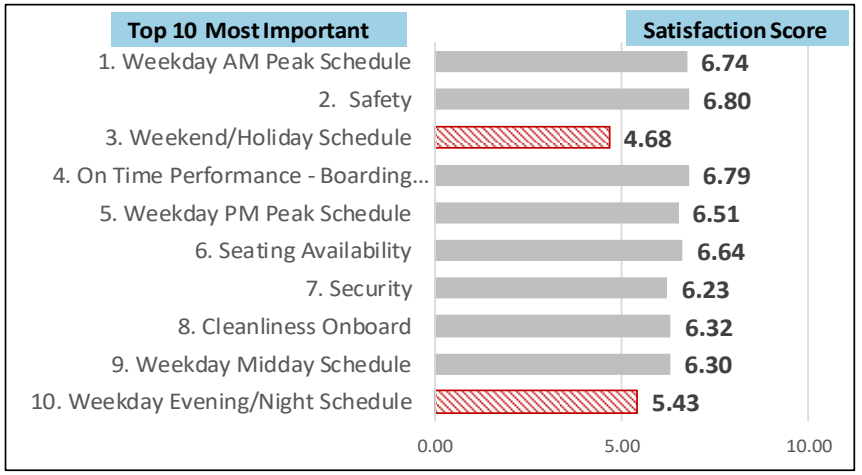
Top 10 Most Important Service Traits for LIGHT RAIL Customers by Light Rail Line and Score

Customer Satisfaction Survey
Fall 2023

LIGHT RAIL SYSTEM

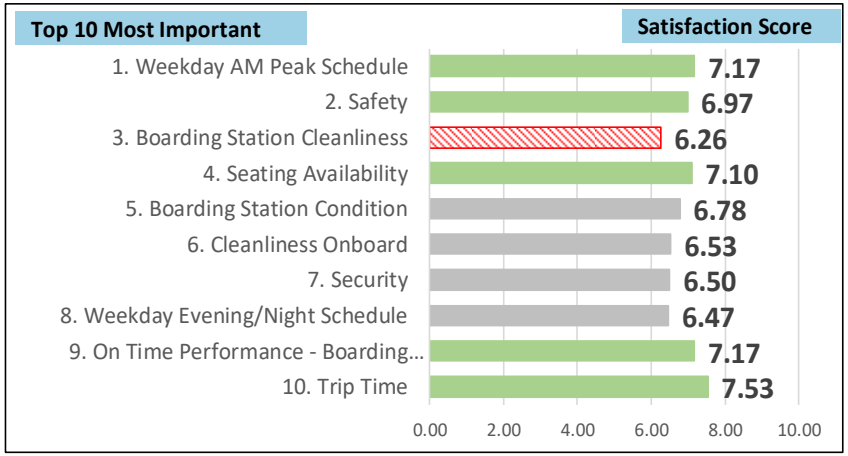


Hudson Bergen Light Rail

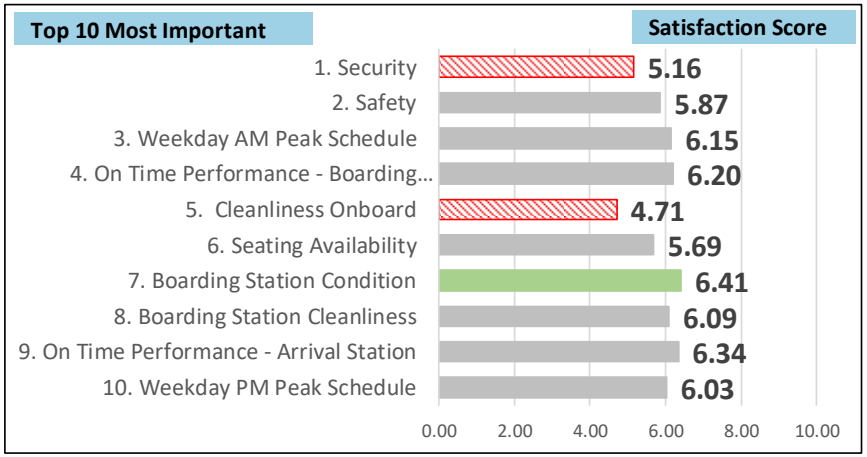


	Top 10 Satisfaction Score
	Bottom 10 Satisfaction Score
	Mid-Range Satisfaction Score

Newark Light Rail



River LINE

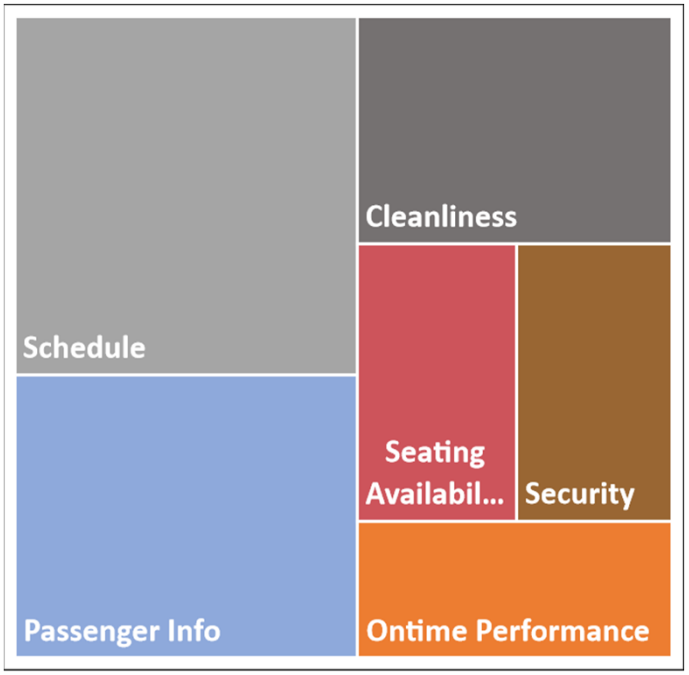


NJ TRANSIT

Top Topic Areas of LIGHT RAIL Comments

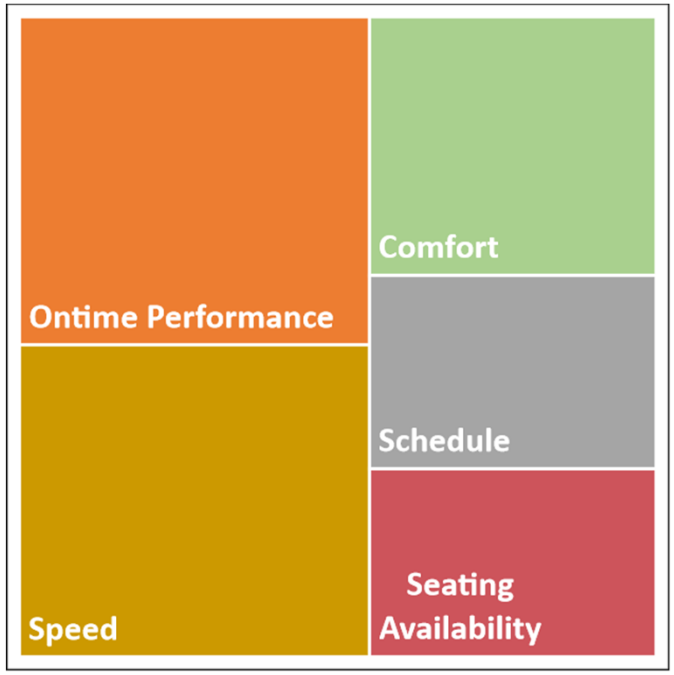
Customer Satisfaction Survey
Fall 2023

What is one thing we can do to **IMPROVE** your travel experience?



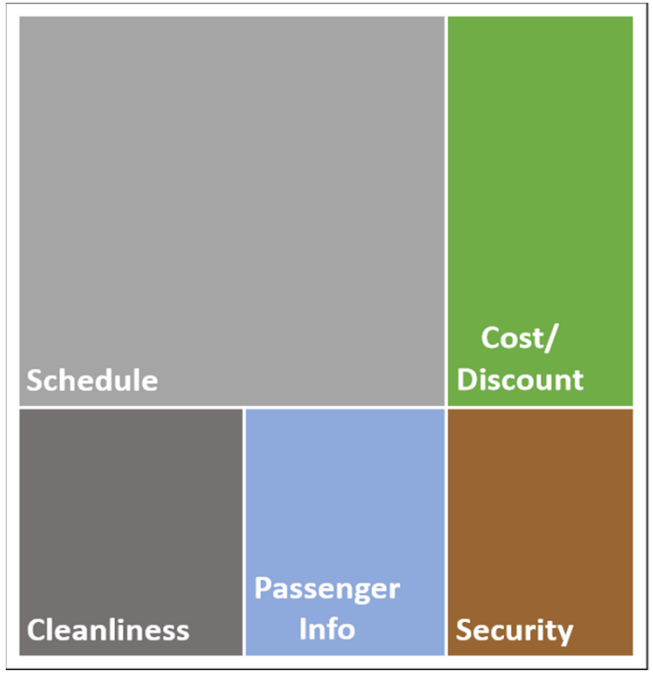
1036 "Improve" Comments

What is one thing that you **LIKED** about your trip on NJ TRANSIT?



982 "Liked" Comments

What are the actions we could take to **ENCOURAGE** you to travel by NJ TRANSIT more frequently?



946 "Encourage" Comments

1,831 Light Rail Surveys

TRANSIT

Customer Satisfaction Survey

Light Rail Score Context

Hudson-Bergen Light Rail

- Overall satisfaction increased due to an enhanced focus on improving on-time performance and train reliability
- Satisfaction with security increased slightly, due to further coordination with NJTPD to address customer complaints, enforce fare collection, and ensure customer safety and security
- Weekend schedule scores remain among the lowest for HBLR as a result of necessary track work and the resulting outages or schedule changes; HBLR continues to work on improving messaging and communications

TRANSIT

Customer Satisfaction Survey

Light Rail Score Context

Newark Light Rail

- An increased focus on improving on-time performance and train reliability has maintained overall customer satisfaction at a 7.1 from the last survey period
- Continued coordination with NJTPD to maintain a presence on the system has helped keep safety and security scores stable
- Scores for station condition dipped very slightly, and we continue our efforts to maintain station cleanliness with increased monitoring and regular maintenance

TRANSIT

Customer Satisfaction Survey

Light Rail Score Context

River Line

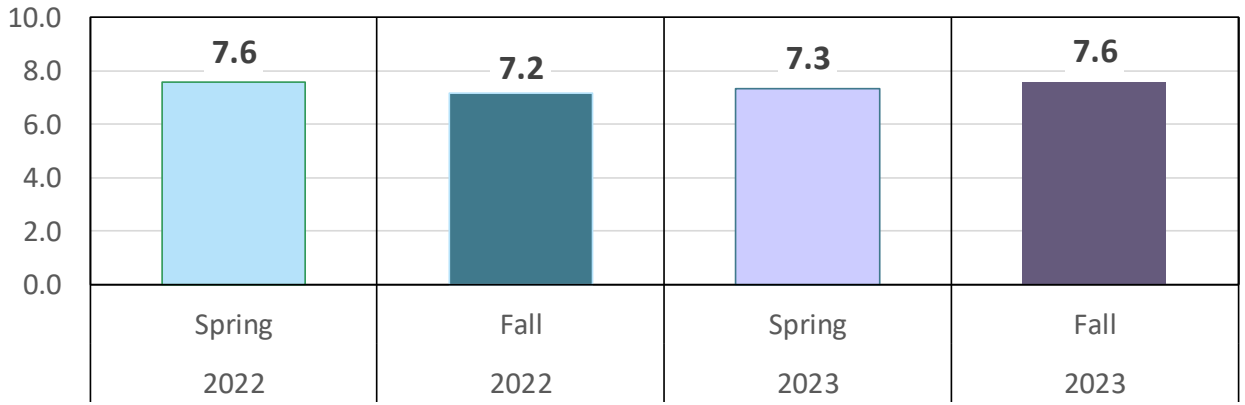
- Overall satisfaction dropped from a 6.4 to a 6.2; however, improvements to the vehicle fleet finalized in October 2023 are expected to increase satisfaction through improved vehicle reliability and service levels
- Efforts to improve communications in the event of a service disruption are ongoing

TRANSIT

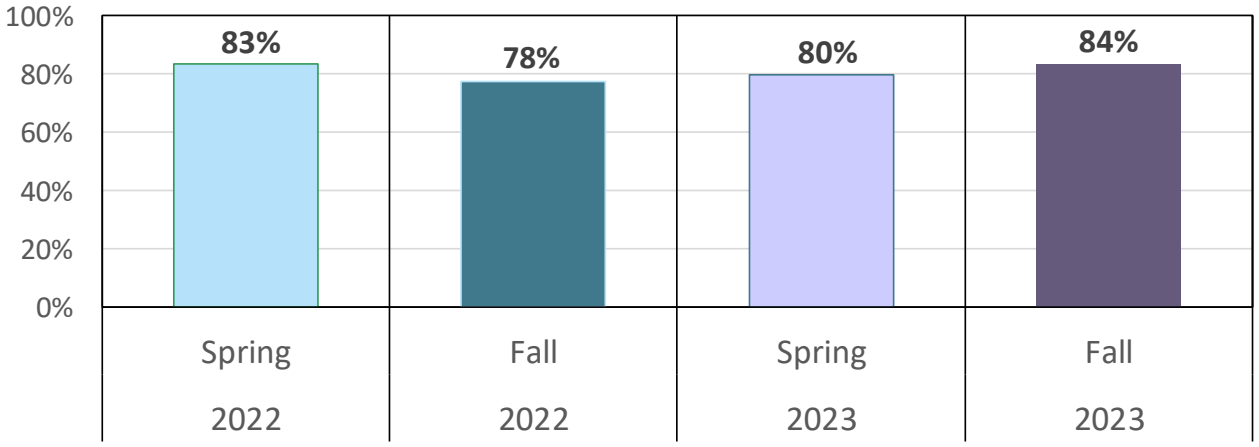
Access Link

Customer Satisfaction Survey
Fall 2023

OVERALL SATISFACTION WITH NJ TRANSIT SCORE



LIKELIHOOD TO RECOMMEND NJ TRANSIT

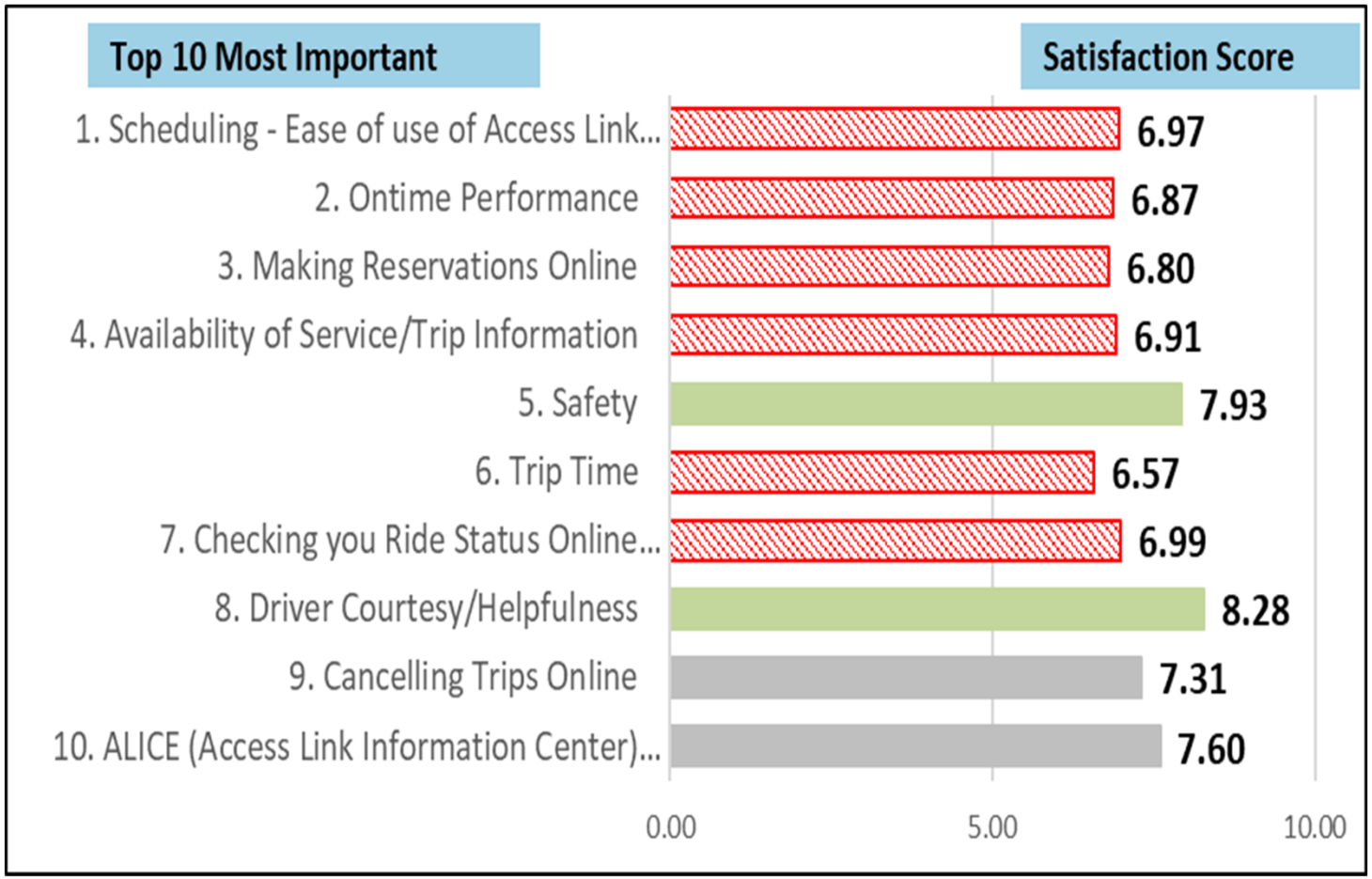


- ACCESS LINK Overall Satisfaction score increased to 7.6 for the Fall 2023 survey from 7.3 in Spring 2022
- Likelihood to Recommend NJ TRANSIT to a friend or family member also increased to 84% from 80% in Spring 2023

TRANSIT

Customer Satisfaction Survey

Fall 2023



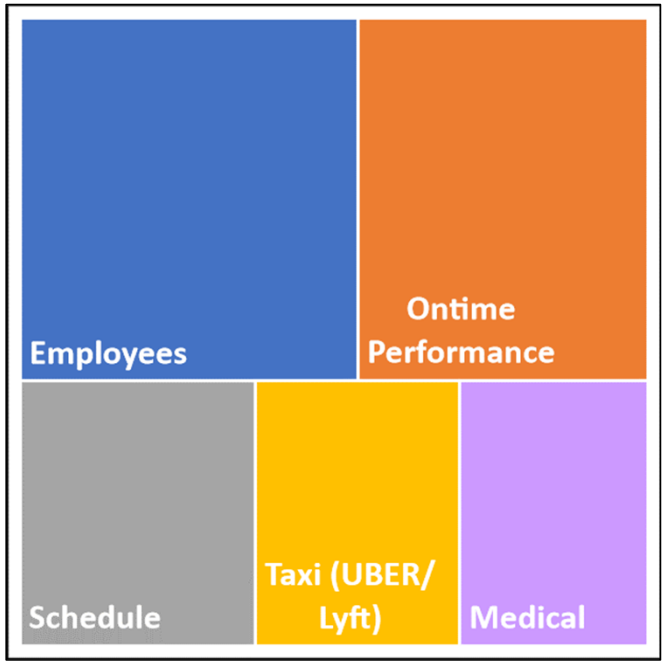
	Top 10 Satisfaction Score
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	Mid-Range Satisfaction Score

NJ TRANSIT

Top Topic Areas of Access Link Comments

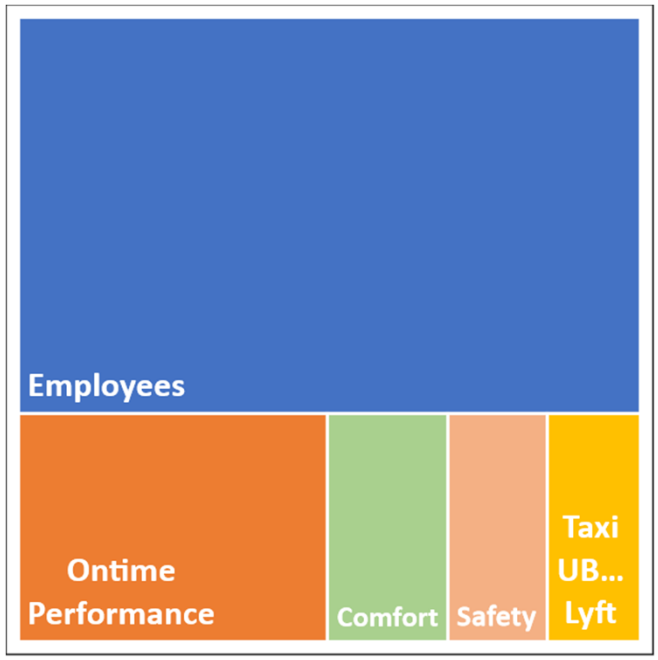
Customer Satisfaction Survey
Fall 2023

What is one thing we can do to **IMPROVE** your travel experience?



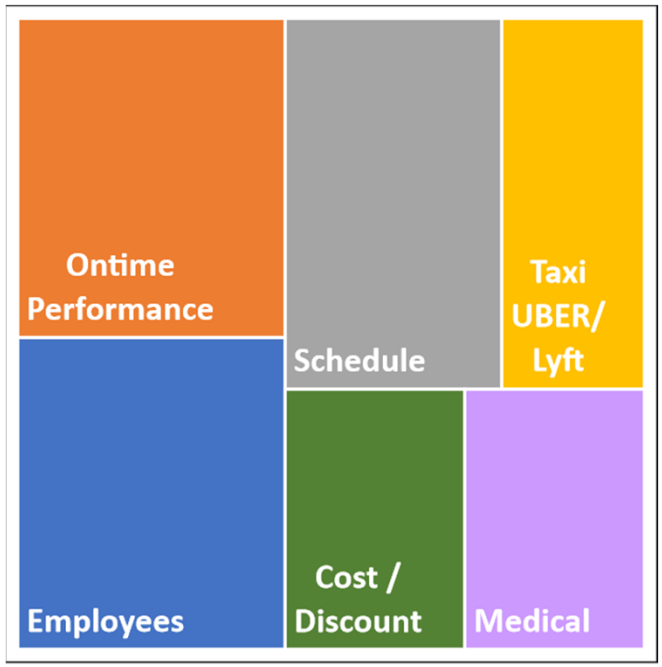
800 "Improve" Comments

What is one thing that you **LIKED** about your trip on NJ TRANSIT?



762 "Liked" Comments

What are the actions we could take to **ENCOURAGE** you to travel by NJ TRANSIT more frequently?



713 "Encourage" Comments

1,363 Access Link Surveys

NJ TRANSIT

Customer Satisfaction Survey

Access Link Score Context

TNC Pilot

- Riders' Choice Pilot Program continues to have a positive impact on the Access Link customer experience
- Initial launch enabled customers in regions 2 and 5 (Burlington, Camden, Essex, Gloucester, Morris, Somerset, Union, and Salem counties) to opt into receiving rides with Uber and Lyft
- Pilot has expanded travel options while enhancing timeliness and efficiency for Access Link
- Expansion of the pilot this February now enables customers in regions 4 and 6 (Mercer, Monmouth, Middlesex, North Ocean, Bergen, Passaic, and Hudson counties) to opt in to receive their rides through Lyft or Black and White Taxi

TRANSIT

Customer Satisfaction Survey

Access Link Score Context

IVR AI (Replicant Software)

- Enhanced interactive voice response (IVR) telephone system launched last spring has helped to hold communication scores steady
- First phase allowed customers to use the automated artificial intelligence system to check ride status and cancel trips
- Added the ability to reserve rides to the system in November 2023
- Virtual Assistant has so far proven to be capable of handling more than 450,000 calls about Status and Cancellations in less than two minutes, and 8,700 calls pertaining to Next Day Reservations in approximately three minutes
- Provides instant service with no hold times and 24/7 availability over the phone
- Increases the availability of live agents to focus on more complex requests
- Absorbs approximately 15-20 percent of calls from Access Link Service Monitor staff

TRANSIT

Customer Satisfaction Survey

Access Link Score Context

On-Time Performance

- Implementation of the Service Infraction (No-Show) policy has contributed to the increase in satisfaction with on-time performance in most regions
- Hosted several outreach events this past fall to educate and prepare customers for the policy change
- Improves on-time performance and ride times by holding customers accountable for trips that arrive at the customer's pick-up location on time, but the customer is not there to board and did not call in advance to cancel their reservation
- Each no-show results in at least a 10-minute delay to a trip while confirmation procedures are followed, in addition to the unnecessary travel time experienced by other customers on that trip
- Uses a progressive scale of warnings and actions for repeated no-shows
- Enables Access Link to better serve customers who are consistently showing up for their pick-ups
- So far approximately 100 customers have been suspended for their accrual of No-Show infractions

NJ TRANSIT

Customer Satisfaction Survey

Summary

- 2023 Fall Overall Satisfaction with NJ TRANSIT Score is 6.7
- 82 percent of customers would recommend NJ TRANSIT – *remains the largest percent to recommend since the survey started*
- The scores and customer comments have been shared with the operating groups and executive management
- Scores will be posted on the NJ TRANSIT website
- The next survey will be administered in the Spring of 2024

NJ TRANSIT